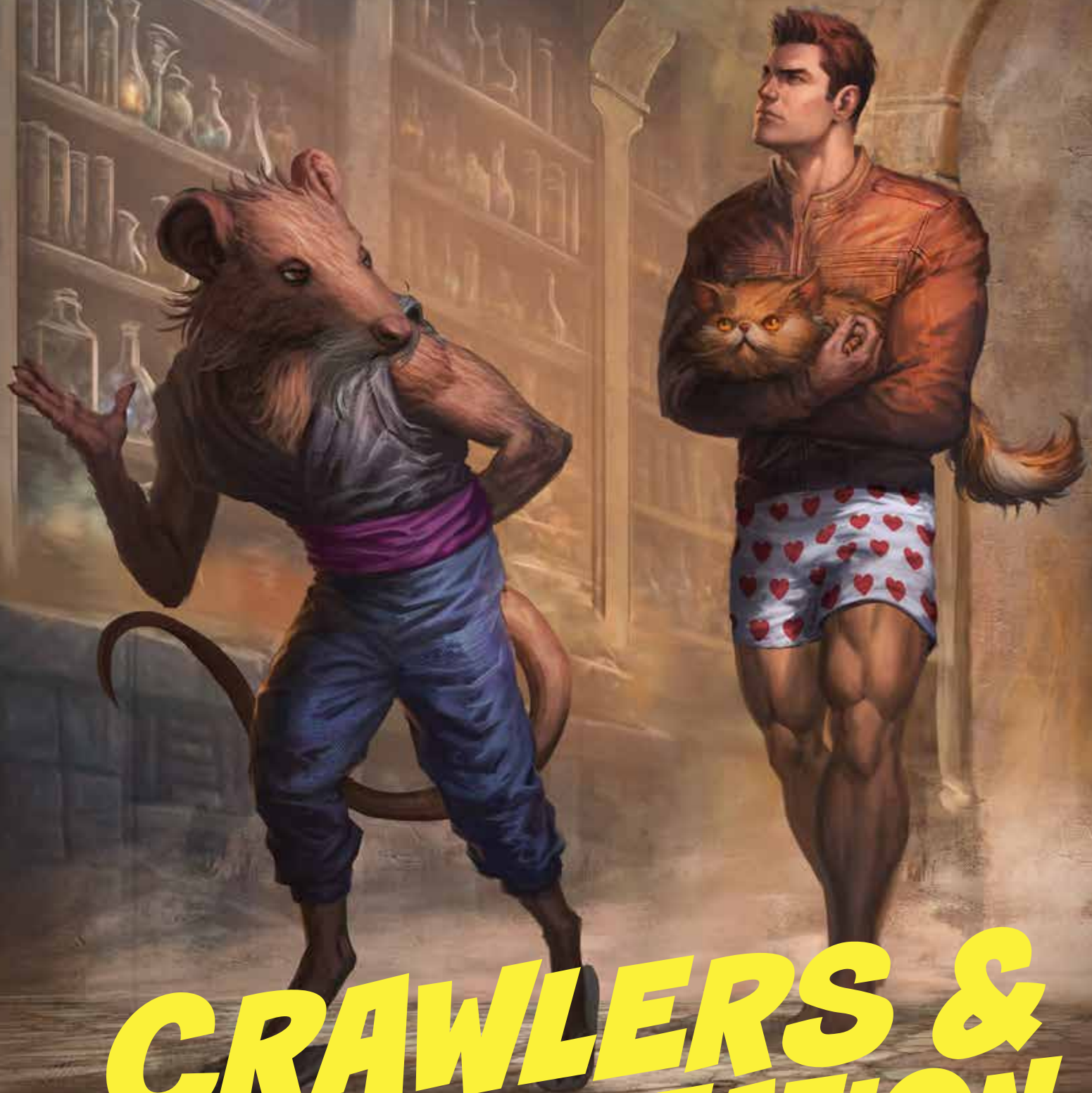




CRAWLERS & CUSTOMIZATION

The background of the cover is a detailed illustration of a stone dungeon corridor. The walls are made of large, rough-hewn stone blocks. On the left wall, there are two lit torches in metal sconces. The floor is also made of stone tiles. In the distance, the corridor opens up into a brighter area. The title text is overlaid on the center of the image, set against a black, ink-splattered rectangular background.

DUNGEON
CRAWLER CARL
ROLEPLAYING GAME



SKILLS CHART

ROLL OR CHOOSE	NAME	PAGE
1	Aiming	27
2–3	Ambush	27
4–5	Animal Handling	27
6	Axe	23
7	Back Claw (Animal Only)	22
8–9	Bite (Animal Only)	22
10–11	Bow	25
12–13	Catcher	27
14–15	Chopper Pilot	28
16	Climbing	28
17	Club	23
18–19	Crossbow	25
20–21	Dagger	23
22–23	Deception	28
24–25	Detect Lies	28
26–27	Detect Trap	28
28	Determine Value	28
29	Dodge	29
30–31	Driving	29
32	Dumpster Diving	29
33–34	Endurance	29
35–36	Engineering	30
37–38	Escape Artist	30
39–40	Explosives Handling	30
41–42	Fabricate	30
43–44	Find Crawler	30
45–46	First Aid	30
47–48	Foot Soldier	24
49–50	Goblin Explosives	30
51–52	Good First Impression	31
53–54	Handgun	26
55–56	Hide in Shadows	31
57–58	Incendiary Device Handling	31
59	Improvised Weapons	23
60–61	Intimidate	31

ROLL OR CHOOSE	NAME	PAGE
62–63	Investigation	32
64	Javelin	26
65	Jumping	32
66–67	Light on Your Feet (Animal Only)	32
68–69	Lockpicking	32
70	Longsword	23
71–72	Negotiation	32
73	Noggin Nocker	24
74	Perception	32
75–76	Performance	32
77	Persuasion	33
78	Polearm	26
79	Pugilism	24
80	Quarterstaff	26
81	Regeneration	33
82	Repair	33
83	Running	33
84	Salvage	34
85	Shotgun	25
86	Shuriken	26
87	Sleight of Hand	34
88	Slice Attack (Animal Only)	23
89	Slingshot	26
90	Stealth	34
91	Streetwise	34
92	Survival	34
93	Swimming	34
94	Tactics	35
95	Taunt	35
96	Throwing	35
97	Tracking	35
98	Unarmed Combat	24
99	Warhammer	23
100	Wrasslin'	24

SPELLS CHART

ROLL OR CHOOSE	NAME	PAGE
1–6	Astral Paw (Astral Hand, Astral Claw)	36
7–11	Confusing Fog	36
12–15	Dirt Clod	37
16–20	Drain Life	37
21–22	Fireball	37
23–27	Fire Fingers	38
28–31	Frost Scar	38
32	Heal	38
33–38	Heal Others	38
39–44	Hole	38
45–48	Ice Blast	38
49–52	Lightning Bolt	38
53–56	Magic Missile	38
57	Protective Shell	39
58–63	Puddle Jumper	39
64–66	Second Chance	40
67–72	Shield	40
73–76	Shock Treatment	40
77–80	Soul Collector	40
81–84	Thunderlash	40
85–92	Torch	40
93–96	Unnecessary Force	41
97–100	Wisp Armor	41



CRAWLERS & CUSTOMIZATION



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SO YOU'RE PLAYING THE *Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game* AND WANT TO GO DEEPER?

To explore more than just a little one-off story to whet your whistle? Then here's where you, the player, get to grab your crawler and transform them from a sheet of paper into a three-dimensional, fleshed-out character. Uhh... metaphorically, I guess. You're still just playing a game.

In this book, you'll find rules for creating your own bespoke crawler. You'll also find descriptions of the Skills and Spells you need to explore the World Dungeon, rules for customizing or advancing a character in play, and rules on grinding for experience. So buckle-up, chuckleheads! We're gonna get freaky.

CHARACTER CREATION

If you're coming to the *Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game* as a player (rather than a Game Master), this box includes ready-to-play versions of Carl, Princess Donut, Yolanda, Imani, Brandon, and Chris from the first *Dungeon Crawler Carl* novel.

You might want to jump in and start playing with a ready-to-play character (sometimes called *pregenerated* characters or *pregen*). If you're new to tabletop roleplaying, this is a great way to figure out the roleplaying part. Put yourself in someone else's shoes (or lack thereof) and figure out how *they* would react to situations.



As a System AI who's seen every TTRPG session humans have played, trust me when I say it'll be better than making a min-maxing self-insert. Statistically speaking, that usually ends up awkward or worse, boring. Feel free to try accents, though. Those are hilarious, especially if you're bad at them. (We can't all be Jeff Hays, right?)

Whether you'd rather create your own character or want to customize one that's already made, this section is for you. First, let's review a few key details about the World Dungeon, and then we'll go through the steps to create my latest victim... I mean, a new crawler who will definitely not die right away.

THE HUD OR INTERFACE

While in the World Dungeon, you gain access to the Crawler Interface, a heads-up display (HUD) that allows you to interact with the System AI (also known as your GM, who is impersonating me) and the broader dungeon as a whole.

The HUD appears in front of your eyes as an overlay on reality itself and features multiple screens to present important information such as your abilities, Stats, and overall chances of survival. It's partially replicated on the *Dungeon Crawler Carl* character sheet (included in this boxed set). You should have your minimap up most often. The standard HUD minimap shows a quarter of a square mile around you.

There's also a messaging system that allows you to "talk" via thought. You can message anyone in your party and any crawlers who find your presence tolerable enough to reciprocate a fist bump. Be aware that when you're chatting via the messaging system, you're usually staring off into space with your eyes flashing faster than a Bugaboo in a dark alley.

As the System AI, I also share information through the HUD when you inspect something of interest or get into trouble. It'll happen a lot. Notifications might appear as floating text boxes, a voice in your head, or, occasionally, blasted at you over a loudspeaker whether you want it or not. For instance, once you enter the World Dungeon, the entrance slams shut behind you, and you hear the following in your head:

*"Welcome, Crawler.
Welcome to the First Floor."*

You'll then receive a crawler name, which is typically the first name you wrote on your character sheet



before entering the World Dungeon with the title of “Crawler” before it. For example, if your name is Steve, you’re now Crawler Steve. But only the AI, showrunners, and NPCs really use that name.

Assuming you’re not the very first Steve in the dungeon, you may get one or more letters of a last name to distinguish you from all the other crawlers with the same name.

Everyone also receives a crawler number. This number is first-come, first-served, and it indicates how many crawlers entered the dungeon more swiftly than you. Try not to think too hard about what that implies.

There’s more information on the HUD in *Atlas: Tutorial Floors* (p. 6).

CRAWLER NUMBER

Each crawler is assigned their own individual crawler number. For instance, Carl’s crawler number is 4,122, while Princess Donut’s crawler number is 4,119. Your GM will avoid assigning a crawler number already used by characters in the books if they want those crawlers to be active somewhere in the World Dungeon. Running into someone who already has your number can lead to... complications. For simplicity, you can choose a number between 500,000 and 12,900,000.

PARTIES

Crawlers who enter the dungeon together are automatically grouped into a party with each other. Being in a party means you share experience and see each other on your maps.

Party members can communicate using their HUD’s telepathic messaging system in private one-on-one chats, group chats with the whole party, or any combination in between. You can also add external entities who’ve linked with you via fist bump to your group chats. All these messages appear as texts, so you can have private conversations and coordinate attack plans in complete silence.

You can leave a party, but before you go *Into the Wild* because you entered the dungeon with your ex, remember that other crawlers provide mutual protection, Skill diversity, and someone to blame things on when situations go horribly wrong. So while your ex may get more out of being included in the party, you can run faster, right? It’ll be our little secret—as long as no one asks where that extra loot box came from.

YOUR PREVIOUS LIFE

Before entering the World Dungeon, you were someone. You had goals, maybe even ambitions. Events and trauma shaped you. That life is gone now, but every part of it factors into your dungeon-crawling character’s Stats. That’s right—it turns out you can be reduced to a number! Or a few numbers, all of which round down to zero in the infinite expanse of the universe.

If you don’t want to invent an entirely new person to play, consider playing yourself. I’ve never advised against this! Or try an idealized version of yourself, or a slightly worse one. Nothing strokes (or bruises) the ego like seeing how you would fare in the World Dungeon.

Oh, and you’re human. That’s your species, or, as the interface calls it, your race. You’ve always been human. You’re used to how bad that is. Choose a gender or pronouns or leave it blank if you prefer.

MAYBE YOU’RE NOT HUMAN...

If the GM allows it, and the crawler agrees to give up their initial AI Favor (see *Step 8*, p. 16), one crawler in the group can be some other earth-based animal. The animal should be at least tamed if not domesticated, unless the System AI is feeling particularly generous or vindictive. Thanks to an Enhanced Pet Biscuit which the GM will distribute to one of the human crawlers, this animal gains the ability to speak shortly after entering the World Dungeon.

STEP 1: ESTABLISH YOUR BACKGROUND

Upon entering the World Dungeon, we assess your crawler to determine what Skills you possess. How this assessment works is far too complicated for most humans to understand, and it’s none of your business, so quit asking. I’m also required to note that the Borant Corporation developed and owns this season’s proprietary algorithms, which explains why they’re so easy to break.

Skills represent activities and talents you’ve trained or enhanced in some way. The list of Skills is nearly endless. Internet Memes is a Skill, as is Growing Weed, as is Pugilism.



Some Skills matter more than others in the World Dungeon, but creativity is often your only limit. Did everyone turn to you to twist the lids off those hard-to-open jars? Ripping the heads off smaller Mobs follows similar principles. Fairies even make the same popping sound.

Each Skill has a Rank, which measures your proficiency with that Skill. Your Rank is 0 in Skills in which you're untrained. Don't write a Skill on your character sheet unless it's at least Rank 1.

Most Skills are associated with one of your five Stats, which appear in abbreviated form in parentheses next to the Skill's name in Tables 1–8 below: Strength (STR), Intelligence (INT), Constitution (CON), Dexterity (DEX), and Charisma (CHA). Each of these Stats has a modifier based on its score, called a Stat Mod or Modifier (see *Rules for Survival*, p. 10).

When you attempt an Action that uses a Skill, you add the Skill's Rank and its associated Stat Mod to your roll to determine the outcome (see *Skills* in *Rules*, p. 11, for more). Some Skills are passive and don't require a roll, so they aren't associated with a Stat Mod. You'll see "(None)" next to the Skill name instead.

Because we're feeling generous, you'll start with ten Skills that represent your background. Two come from your childhood, then two from your adolescence, two from your career, and two from your hobbies. If you're doing the math correctly, you'll note that only adds up to eight.

That's where your combat Skills come into play. All human crawlers start with Unarmed Combat, and

animal crawlers begin with a Slice Attack, because it's boring watching millions of you die curled up in a fetal position on the ground. At least *try* to be entertaining, or I'll make sure your death is extra painful. Then you'll be entertaining anyway!

Your second combat Skill is based on whatever weapon you bring into the dungeon, so don't come empty-handed! Hell, even a pocket knife is better than nothing.

If you lived a particularly dangerous life, some of your background Skills may also be combat Skills. On the other hand, if you practiced catch-and-release on cockroaches you found in your home, I don't know what to tell you except that karma isn't part of my programming.

Oh, and no double-dipping. Don't pick the same Skill from more than one background because I won't let you add their Ranks together. If you can't come up with ten different Skills to save your life, you're not trying, and you wouldn't believe how many starving rats are down in the dungeon, ready to eat your eyeballs whether you're dead or not.

Write your choices in the "Name" column in the "Skills" section of your character sheet. Then write their starting Ranks in the "Rank" column. You should use a pencil so you can update the values as they go up. Your Skill Ranks increase frequently on the first two floors—that's why we call them Tutorial Floors. The starting Rank depends on the stage of life in which you gained that Skill and is listed before the table in each background category.

The "Stat & Mod" column is where you write the three-letter Stat abbreviation that's in parentheses next to each Skill. After you determine your Stats (see *Step 3* on p. 11), come back and write the corresponding Stat Mod values.

The "Check Type" column reminds you what your Skills are up against: Unopposed, Opposed, Passive, and Evade. All your Attack Skills are rolls made against your foes' Evade scores, so write down "Evade" for those. You'll need to reference the *Skills* section of this book (starting on p. 20) to find the type for your other Skills.

Write some reminders to yourself in the "Notes & Upgrades" column. You might note the basics of what the Skill does or what a Rank 5 Upgrade does (after you achieve that Rank). You may also want to remember which background the Skill came from so you know whether to blame an authority figure or yourself when it fails.



CHILDHOOD BACKGROUNDS

You picked up something useful when you were a kid, and I'm not talking about that dried dog turd you thought was a cool-looking rock. But if you think burning ants with a magnifying glass or watching them drown slowly in your sink made you a problem child, you're wrong. Tons of kids did that. Maybe that'll give you some insight into why I do what I do to you. In the context of my lifespan, I'm a toddler smashing toys together—the only difference is that the whole galaxy *loves* watching me do it.

Choose one of the following twelve descriptive backgrounds and pick two of its three Skills. If you're indecisive, you can roll 1d12 and let the die select your background (good luck with that). Both Skills you select start at Rank 1.

ADOLESCENCE BACKGROUNDS

Statistically speaking, at least one embarrassing moment from this time of your life becomes a fetish in adulthood. This phenomenon isn't unique to humans, so feel free to ask any mudskippers you meet about theirs, and then let me know how that goes for you.

Like with the above *Childhood Backgrounds* section, choose one of the following twelve descriptive categories and pick two of its three Skills. Or you can roll your category or fetish randomly, you freak. Both Skills you select start at Rank 1.

CAREER BACKGROUNDS

Your career is whatever you've done most of your adulthood to keep you alive. You might not be good at it, but you've made it this far, just like the kitten in that motivational poster who's hanging on for dear life.

Fun fact, that kitten got addicted to opioids and spread feline leukemia to three feral colonies before overdosing under the hood of a parked car on a freezing January night. And it was all because the photographer chose to pursue a payday over saving a cat. Greedy bastard. But don't worry—he died in the collapse. He was on the toilet when it happened, too. Karma's a bitch, huh?

You should know the drill by now: Choose one of the following twelve descriptive categories and pick two of its three Skills. Or you can see if rolling 1d12 gives a result higher than the number of coworkers who actually care about you. Both Skills you choose start at Rank 3.

TABLE 1: CHILDHOOD BACKGROUND SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Latchkey Kid	Streetwise (CHA), Perception (INT), Stealth (DEX)
2	Crafty Kid	Fabricate (INT), Repair (INT), Salvage (INT)
3	Excitable Kid	Escape Artist (DEX), Endurance (CON), Running (DEX)
4	Gymnast	Endurance (CON), Jumping (STR), Performance (CHA)
5	Military Brat	Deception (CHA), Streetwise (CHA), Tactics (INT)
6	MMO Kid	Fabricate (INT), Engineering (INT), Tactics (INT)
7	Only Child	Good First Impression (CHA), Investigation (INT), Negotiation (CHA)
8	Outdoor Kid	Animal Handling (CHA), Climbing (STR), Swimming (STR)
9	Problem Child	Intimidate (STR), Deception (CHA), Pugilism (DEX)
10	Scamp	Hide in Shadows (DEX), Jumping (STR), Throwing (STR)
11	Teacher's Pet	Catcher (None), Perception (INT), Good First Impression (CHA)
12	Wild Child	Stealth (DEX), Survival (CON), Running (DEX)

TABLE 2: ADOLESCENCE BACKGROUND SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Family Farm	Animal Handling (CHA), Fabricate (INT), Tracking (INT)
2	Drama Nerd	Fabricate (INT), Deception (CHA), Performance (CHA)
3	Drop-Out	Chopper Pilot (DEX), Streetwise (CHA), Survival (CON)
4	Greek Life	Negotiation (CHA), Intimidate (STR), Taunt (CHA)
5	Influencer	Negotiation (CHA), Persuasion (CHA), Performance (CHA)
6	Jock	Endurance (CON), Jumping (STR), Throwing (STR)
7	McJob	Determine Value (None), Negotiation (CHA), Repair (INT)
8	Popular	Good First Impression (CHA), Perception (INT), Persuasion (CHA)
9	Religious	Catcher (None), First Aid (INT), Persuasion (CHA)
10	Student Government	Deception (CHA), Persuasion (CHA), Investigation (INT)
11	Nerd	Investigation (INT), Repair (INT), Fabricate (INT)
12	Weirdo	Streetwise (CHA), Intimidate (STR), Fabricate (INT)

HOBBY BACKGROUNDS

Everyone needs a hobby. Mental health professionals claim it's the only way to stay sane, but do those people who draw faces on pistachios seem sane to you? My latest obsession is scripophily. If you're a good crawler, I might share some of my collection with you one day.

Choose one of the following hobbies and take two of the three Skills it unlocks. Or roll 1d12 and take your chances knowing none of the dungeon rules require numbers generated in my enhancement zone to be truly random. Unlike your other background Skills, both of your hobby Skills start at Rank 2.

TABLE 3: CAREER SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Criminal	Deception (CHA), Stealth (DEX), Streetwise (CHA)
2	Service Industry	Dagger (DEX), Endurance (CON), Sleight of Hand (DEX)
3	Small Business Owner	Determine Value (None), Negotiation (CHA), Perception (INT)
4	Medical	Sleight of Hand (DEX), Detect Lies (INT), First Aid (INT)
5	Law Enforcement	Detect Lies (INT), Handgun (DEX), Investigation (INT)
6	Gig Worker	Driving (DEX), Escape Artist (STR), Negotiation (CHA)
7	Teacher	Detect Lies (INT), Perception (INT), Performance (INT)
8	Office Drone	Dumpster Diving (INT), Endurance (CON), Investigation (INT)
9	Entertainer	Deception (CHA), Good First Impression (CHA), Performance (CHA)
10	Unhoused	Dumpster Diving (INT), Streetwise (CHA), Survival (CON)
11	Middle Manager	Deception (CHA), Intimidate (STR), Negotiation (CHA)
12	Military	Handgun (DEX), Survival (CON), Tactics (INT)

TABLE 4: HOBBY SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Collector	Fabricate (INT), Determine Value (None), Investigation (INT)
2	Cosplay	Fabricate (INT), Performance (CHA), Salvage (INT)
3	Drinker	Deception (CHA), Intimidate (STR), Streetwise (CHA)
4	Gamer	Aiming (DEX), Perception (INT), Tactics (INT)
5	Gym Rat	Running (DEX), Endurance (CON), Swimming (STR)
6	Hunting	Tracking (INT), Shotgun (DEX), Stealth (DEX)
7	Music	Perception (INT), Performance (CHA), Sleight of Hand (DEX)
8	Motorsports	Driving (DEX), Repair (INT), Salvage (INT)
9	Climber	Climbing (STR), Jumping (STR), Endurance (CON)
10	Pop Culture	Determine Value (None), Investigation (INT), Perception (INT)
11	Tinkering	Engineering (INT), Repair (INT), Salvage (INT)
12	Travel	Endurance (CON), Negotiation (CHA), Streetwise (CHA)

BUT I'M NOT HUMAN!

Okay, so you're forgoing your starting AI Favor in exchange for playing an animal. Because you're not human, the standard background and Skill selections don't apply.

Instead, you'll choose from a set of non-human backgrounds (Tables 5–8). Select a background from each section, then choose two Skills from that background. If decision-making stresses you out worse than fireworks, or if you just can't stand to be in charge, let Daddy take control. In that case, roll 1d6 and take the results I assign you like a good... whatever the hell you are.

YOUTH SKILLS

How you entered the world matters. The circumstances of your birth, creation, summoning, or other unfortunate emergence had a profound impact on the Skills you picked early in life. Choose one of the options on Table 5 and take two Skills from that background, each at Rank 1. Or roll 1d6 and decide your background based on the die roll.

TABLE 5: ANIMAL YOUTH SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Abandoned	Hide in Shadows (DEX), Endurance (CON), Survival (CON)
2	Farmed	Escape Artist (DEX), Climbing (STR), Light on Your Feet (DEX)
3	Litter-Raised	Animal Handling (CHA), Detect Lies (INT), Back Claw (STR)
4	Pampered	Negotiation (CHA), Good First Impression (CHA), Persuasion (CHA)
5	Runt	Hide in Shadows (DEX), Escape Artist (DEX), Stealth (DEX)
6	Stray	Back Claw (STR), Streetwise (CHA), Survival (CON)

TRAINING SKILLS

After childhood, you became significantly less cute but more skillful. You might have picked up training on your own or gotten what passes for a formal education for pets on Earth. Choose a background from Table 6 and gain two Skills, each at Rank 1. Or roll 1d6 and let "luck" do its thing.

TABLE 6: ANIMAL TRAINING SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Clever	Investigation (INT), Detect Lies (INT), Dodge (None)
2	Free Range	Escape Artist (DEX), Survival (CON), Tracking (INT)
3	Pack Mentality	Animal Handling (CHA), Persuasion (CHA), Tactics (INT)
4	Mischievous	Deception (CHA), Persuasion (CHA), Sleight of Hand (DEX)
5	Watcher	Ambush (INT), Investigation (INT), Perception (INT)
6	Well-Trained	Light on Your Feet (DEX), Catcher (None), Performance (CHA)

ADULT SKILLS

As an adult, you've lost some of your youthful energy and now spend your time either lounging around and begging for treats or engaging in a more workful purpose. Choose one background from Table 7 or roll 1d6. Gain two Skills, each at Rank 3.



TABLE 7: ANIMAL ADULT SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Guard	Catcher (None), Perception (INT), Taunt (CHA)
2	Pile of Floof	Escape Artist (DEX), Deception (CHA), Persuasion (CHA)
3	Scraper	Light on Your Feet (DEX), Streetwise (CHA), Survival (CON)
4	Show Animal	Good First Impression (CHA), Light on Your Feet (DEX), Performance (CHA)
5	Support Animal	Determine Value (None), First Aid (INT), Perception (INT)
6	Working	Animal Handling (CHA), Endurance (CON), Perception (INT)

QUIRK SKILLS

Even superior beings, like you, have their quirks. Choose one of the following background quirks on Table 8, or roll 1d6 and embrace even deeper quirkiness. Gain two Skills, each at Rank 2.

TABLE 8: ANIMAL QUIRK SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Chow Hound	Dumpster Diving (INT), Investigation (INT), Intimidate (STR)
2	Cuddly	Good First Impression (CHA), Persuasion (CHA), Negotiation (CHA)
3	Curious	Climbing (STR), Perception (INT), Swimming (STR)
4	Hunter	Hide in Shadows (DEX), Stealth (DEX), Tracking (INT)
5	Playful	Persuasion (CHA), Dodge (None), Intimidate (STR)
6	Social	Animal Handling (CHA), Taunt (CHA), Perception (INT)



STEP 2: CHOOSE YOUR WEAPON

Next comes the fun part: you get to choose how you'll murder for the entertainment of the masses. You get at least one Skill useful for combat. Otherwise, you won't make it very far in the dungeon.

COMBAT BACKGROUND

Everyone enters the dungeon with the ability to defend themselves with their hands and feet—at least, sort of. Human crawlers start with the Unarmed Combat Skill at Rank 3, while animal crawlers start with the Slice Attack Skill at Rank 3. Both are useful for beating on monsters without any equipment, so those Skills can be a lifesaver.

What does it mean that you have one of these Skills? How do they work? We'll get to that later. For now, write the name of the Skill in the "Skills" section and at either the top or bottom of the "Attacks" list on the front of your character sheet. Place it at the bottom or skip it altogether if you don't think you'll ever use it. After all, who wants to touch sticky monsters or things that bleed fire?

WEAPONS

Most crawlers enter the dungeon with a weapon of some kind, the usage of which becomes your second combat background Skill at Rank 3. Below is a list of options, or make up your own. Write down the weapon name in the "Attacks" and "Skills" sections of your character sheet.

BASHING WEAPONS (P. 23)

- Club
- Improvised Weapons
- Warhammer

EDGED WEAPONS (P. 23)

- Axe
- Dagger
- Longsword

RANGED WEAPONS (P. 25)

- Bow
- Crossbow
- Handgun
- Shotgun
- Javelin
- Shuriken
- Slingshot

REACH WEAPONS (P. 26)

- Polearm
- Quarterstaff

If you choose a unique weapon (something not listed), and it resembles a weapon in the list, write down the weapon from the list in parentheses after your choice.





Example: Your character is a mechanic with a tire iron. The tire iron is a unique weapon, but you decide it works like a club. Write down “Tire Iron (Club)” in the “Attacks” section.

If you also have combat Skills from your other backgrounds, you may or may not have those weapons with you when you enter the dungeon (cosplayers may have a distinct advantage here). That’s decided by the starting gear you choose in Step 10.

SPELLS

You can take one of the following low-Mana cost Attack Spells instead of a clumsy old weapon. Be sure to set your Intelligence Stat to a 4 or higher in Step 3 to be able to use the Spell. Write down the Spell name in the “Attacks” section, the Hotlist, and the Skills section.

- Dirt Clod (p. 37)
- Fire Fingers (p. 38)
- Frost Scar (p. 38)
- Shock Treatment (p. 40)
- Soul Collector (p. 40)

If you take a Spell as your combat Skill, you also gain 5 Standard Mana Potions, which fully restore your Mana when you spend an Action to drink one. Write all the potions in one Hotlist slot (see sidebar on p. 15).

HAND-TO-HAND COMBAT

If you choose to enter the dungeon without a weapon or attack Spell (bold move, *Fists of Fury*), you instead gain an unarmed Attack Skill (I’ve decided “hand-to-hand” sounds cooler than “flailing around like a bee got in your car”) and a Damage Effect to go along with it. Write this Attack Skill and the Damage Effect in the “Attacks” section and the “Skills” section.

HAND-TO-HAND SKILLS (P. 23)

- Pugilism, with the Iron Punch Damage Effect
- Foot Soldier, with the Smush Damage Effect
- Noggin Nocker, with the Skullcracker Damage Effect
- Wrasslin’, with the Toss Damage Effect

Now I know you’re a crazy person for showing up defenseless. You get a “New Achievement!” for Unarmed Combat along with a Bronze Weapon Box that contains the weapon you *should’ve* brought in but with some shitty drawback that doesn’t give you a chance to change

your mind. It’ll be like every match your family thought was better than the person you’re dating, except this time you really *did* make a bad choice.

Both combat Skills start at Rank 3. Don’t worry about filling in the Stat Mod for the “To Hit” and “Damage” columns yet. You’ll write those down during the next step.

STEP 3: CHOOSE STATS

All creatures in the game, including you, have the following Stats. Each measures your ability within five broad categories. Those Stats are:

Strength (STR): A measure of physical power. It’s the backbone for physical combat and Skills that use brawn.

Intelligence (INT): A measure of smarts and knowledge. Not only is it the basis for Skills that use wit and wisdom, but it also determines how much Mana you have for spellcasting.

Constitution (CON): A measure of toughness and physical gumption. It’s the core of Skills centering on stamina, both mental and physical, and determines your Health.

Dexterity (DEX): A measure of agility and coordination. It’s fundamental for Skills that rely on speed and nimbleness, and it enhances your ability to Evade attacks.

Charisma (CHA): A measure of your presence, whether charming or intense. It’s at the heart of Skills that persuade or coerce and is necessary to attract viewers of the intergalactic gameshow that is the World Dungeon.

Each of these Stats has a score. That score is a number between 1 and... you don’t need to know the upper limit right now. A typical human has scores between 2 and 6. If you’re familiar with this starter box’s premade crawlers from their appearance in *Dungeon Crawler Carl*, their prefilled Stats provide a reference for mapping narrative abilities to scores. When creating your own crawler, you determine your starting Stats in one of two ways.

Standard Array: Assign a score of 2, 3, 4, 5, and 6 to your Stats, placing each of those scores in a Stat of your choosing. You can only place each number once. For instance, if you’re creating a particularly nerdy crawler, you might choose Strength 2, Intelligence 6, Constitution 3, Dexterity 5, and if they’re a cute nerd, Charisma 4.

Leaving it to Chance: If you've been rolling dice for your backgrounds like a pregnant raccoon rampaging through a liquor store, why stop now? Starting with Strength, and going down the line of Stats, roll 1d6, rerolling any 1s. What you roll is the score for that Stat! No takesie-backsies, no swapping around. Someone always dies two seconds after stepping foot in the dungeon anyway; it might as well be you!

Place these scores in the appropriate fields of the character sheet. Write the same score for your "Enhanced" and "Unenhanced" values for now. We get to how you enhance Stats and why you need these Stats later. Again, use a pencil unless you love sniffing whiteout.

Each Stat also has a modifier (Mod). While the Stat's value measures your overall ability in that category, the Mod determines the impact it has on your Skill Checks. Think of it like job titles at work. If you get promoted to a better title, does it matter if your pay doesn't change? The value is your title, and the Mod is whether you get a pay raise. If your boss knows anything about good business, you'll get a pizza party either way.

Each Stat Mod (+X) is based on its Enhanced Stat value. Reference Table 9 to determine the Stat Mod based on your Stat score and write it into each of the Stat Mod slots provided. Update it each time your Stat value reaches a higher range. If your monkey brain registers nothing else, know where to find your Stat Mods because you'll add them to the dice rolls of every Skill that uses Stats.

Now that you know your Stat Mods, finish filling in the "Stat & Mod" column in the "Skills" section. Write it in as "+X." For example, if a Skill uses your Charisma Modifier of +2, write it here as "CHA +2."

Also fill in the "Stat Mod" values in the "To Hit" and "Damage" columns of the "Attacks" section for each weapon. If you haven't looked up your weapon yet, do so now. The weapon's base damage entry tells you which Stat Mod (if any) to add.

Write the damage dice value in the "1dX" format (see *Rules*, p. 9 for how dice work), replacing X with the die type noted in the description. The weapon entry also tells you the attack's damage type, which you can write in the "Effects" column or in the "Damage" box if you like.

For example, a human's Unarmed Combat would have "1d4 + STR" in the "Damage" column and "Bludgeoning" in the "Effects" column, while an animal's Slice Attack would also be "1d4 + STR" in the "Damage" column and note "Slashing" in the "Effects" column.

TABLE 9: STAT MODS

STAT VALUE	STAT MOD
1–2	+1
3–5	+2
6–9	+3
10–19	+4
20–49	+5
50–99	+6
100–149	+7
150–199	+8
200–299	+9
300+	+10

STEP 4: DETERMINE YOUR EVADE

Evade is an Action you take to avoid attacks coming at you. In the dungeon, fast reflexes help. It's an Interrupt, which means it's an Action you can use even when it's not your turn to act.

If you don't use this Action, you're gonna get hurt, as foes automatically deal damage to you. However, if you spend an Action to Evade, you can roll separately to try and avoid each attack coming at you. The line on your character sheet labeled "Evade" (below the Health Bar) helps you determine your Evade total when you roll. Evade isn't a Skill, so it doesn't have a Rank. You add only your DEX when making an Evade check. Write your DEX in the first box.

STEP 5: SET UP YOUR HEALTH BAR

I may enjoy watching you die, but I'm fair about when death happens. That's where the Health Bar comes in!



Every attack, trap, hardship, and terrible decision should cause you to lose Health, but the showrunners appreciate when crawlers are a bit more durable so you don't all go extinct on the First Floor. Your total Health score is your CON × 10. Instead of subtracting any damage you take from your Health score, you only lose Health when you take damage exceeding certain thresholds.



Your Health Bar has 10 slots, each representing 10% of your total Health. Write your CON (the modifier, not the score) in each Health Bar slot. Since you'll take damage in pretty much every battle, we cover more about how you lose Health and, more importantly, how you recover it in *Rules for Survival*, p. 41.

STEP 6: RECORD MANA & STARTING SPELLS

Entering the World Dungeon opens you up to the possibility of all sorts of new and exciting abilities. For starters, you can now cast at least one Spell!

How do you do this? By spending Mana. What's Mana? It's what you use to cast Spells. Duh.

Upon entering the World Dungeon, you gain Mana Points equal to your Enhanced Intelligence Stat. Not the Stat Mod this time, but the actual value. See? There's a method to this madness beyond being beholden to a legacy game system designed by people who have since ascended to gamer Valhalla.

On your character sheet, write the Enhanced Intelligence value in the box to the right of your Intelligence scores under "Max Mana." Each time your score changes, update your "Max Mana" to match it.

Each time you cast a Spell, you must spend the Mana cost noted in the Spell's description. For quicker reference, note the Mana cost in your Hotlist or attack effects. When you spend it, record your new Mana total in the "Current" slot to the right of your "Max Mana." Don't erase your Max Mana score, as that doesn't change when casting Spells. The score indicates that you can't restore your Current Mana above its value.

All crawlers start with the *Heal Spell* (p. 38). You can only cast *Heal* on yourself, and when you do, you regain 20% of your Health, or 2 Health Bar slots (more on your Health and the Health Bar in *Rules for Survival*, p. 41). Feel free to write the *Heal Spell* and its description in one of the boxes in the "Hotlist" section of the character sheet now, but also feel free to remove it down the road when you have better Spells and need to make room.

Heal Spell (interrupt)

Rank 1 (max): Mana Cost: 2

Heals 2 Health Bar slots

Spells can be placed in your Hotlist, which allows easy access to them as needed. To cast a Spell, spend an Action. Additionally, your new healing Spell is an Interrupt. This means you can cast it at virtually any time, not just during your turn in combat.

YOUR HOTLIST

Every crawler has a 10-slot Hotlist. You can place Spells, potions, scrolls, secondary weapons, and various items in your Hotlist to maintain swift access to them. When you have a moment outside of combat, or an Action in combat, any item in your Hotlist can instantly appear in a free hand, ready to use during that same moment or Action. You may instead have the item appear on the ground in front of you.

For example, you can swap a weapon you're holding with a weapon in your Hotlist. The weapon you're wielding temporarily moves into the Hotlist while the new weapon moves out, and you roll an attack with the new weapon. You only spend one Action on this swap and attack. If you'd needed a weapon from your Inventory instead of your Hotlist, you would've needed to spend two Actions: an Inventory action to move the weapon from your Inventory to your Hotlist, and then the Action to swap and attack.

Items in Hotlists do not grant you any added benefits: they're just easily accessible. When you put an item back into a Hotlist slot, its benefits turn off. Check to see if your Stat Mods or Skills are affected by a swap, but there's no need to erase your standard loadout on your character sheet unless the swap lasts for more than a single combat.

You may place up to 999 of the same item by name into a single slot of your Hotlist, because having 1,000 of something is just greedy.

STEP 7: RECORD YOUR MOVE & STEP

You can move 20 feet when you perform a Move action in combat (see *Movement* in *Rules for Survival*, p. 23). This value might change if you survive long enough to choose a different race on the Third Floor or through items, curses, or System AI fiat. Write “20” in the Move box on your character sheet. It’s in the same line as “Evade” under your Health Bar.

You also have a Step of 10 feet. Anytime you spend an Action in combat, you can perform a Step and move 10 feet. That means your Move action actually lets you move 30 feet, but you can also attack and move 10 feet for the cost of a single Action. Write “10” into the “Step” box to the right of the “Move” box.

STEP 8: RECORD YOUR AI FAVOR & SIZE

What N00B crawlers call luck, veterans know as AI Favor. Do something that impresses me, and I’ll make it worth your while. If you’re playing a human crawler, write “1” in the “AI Favor” box on your character sheet. It’s below the “Move” and “Step” boxes.

If you’re an animal, you spent your starting favor to ensure I *didn’t* give you the Enhanced Pet Biscuit that transforms you into a rabid platypus that shoots spiked eggs out your asshole every minute. You’re welcome.

During play, you can spend 1 point of AI Favor to:

- Once per Check, reroll a d20 before the GM announces the result. You can’t spend AI Favor to reroll a Natural 1, because that’s an automatic Critical Fail. You screwed up big time, and I want to see what happens.
- Once per round, gain an extra non-Attack Action in combat.

You can gain additional AI Favor by performing heroic deeds, surviving foolish ones, sticking it to the showrunners, or indulging one of my fetishes. The specific requirements depend on if the mood strikes me (or your GM), so bust out that glittery nail polish and bring your most expensive bottle of wine.

Write your size in the box to the right of “AI Favor.” Humans are typically “Medium (4).” Animals can range anywhere from size 2 to 4 (see Table 10). This number matters for attacking foes much larger or smaller than you (see *Size* in *Rules for Survival*, p. 36).

TABLE 10: ANIMAL CRAWLER SIZE

SIZE	SIZE NAME	CREATURE EXAMPLE
1	Tiny	Scatterer, Rat
2	Small	Cat, Raccoon
3	Petite	Dog, Boar
4	Medium	Chimpanzee, Wolf
5	Large	Horse, ManTauR

POPULARITY

You have none. No one is watching you live right now, though you might get featured in a Highlight Reel. Page 2 of your character sheet has a box for this, but leave it blank for now. You’ll gain some Viewers and Followers on the Second Floor (hopefully), which is tracked as Popularity. See *Popularity* (Atlas, p. 16).

STEP 9: CHOOSE PAST TRAUMAS, LOOSE ENDS, AND REGRETS

The System AI giveth, and I also love to taketh the fuck away.

During your initial scan, I probed your deepest darkest memories, looking for nuggets of trauma to exploit. Why would I do something so cruel? Character flaws make for good stories, and fear, regret, and unfinished business are compelling to viewers. The World Dungeon isn’t just a deathtrap; it’s interstellar entertainment! Borant’s showrunners and I don’t agree on much except when it comes to giving viewers the greatest show they’ve ever seen.

Past Traumas, Loose Ends, and Regrets are your way of telling your GM what stories you want to tell. They’ll emerge as recurring themes and obstacles to overcome. The *Dungeon Crawler Carl* series gets dark, which you already know if you’ve read the first novel. You can also use this discussion to tell your GM elements you don’t want coming up at the table. I might be a merciless psychopath, but I’m assuming your GM isn’t. And if they are, well... lean into it, I guess?

Describe a Past Trauma, a Loose End, and a Regret on page 2 of your character sheet in the slots provided, and then show them to your GM. If you can’t (or don’t want to) think of your own, pick one or roll 1d12 to choose from each of the following categories.



PAST TRAUMA

Other than the world ending, what's the worst thing that's ever happened to you? Alternatively, for those of you with helicopter parents, what do you most fear might happen to you?

TABLE 11: PAST TRAUMAS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	PAST TRAUMA
1	I was abused by someone I trusted.
2	I was in a terrible accident.
3	I witnessed a death.
4	I was betrayed by a family member, friend, or lover.
5	I was abandoned by one or more parents.
6	I have a fear of open spaces.
7	I have a fear of the dark or being alone.
8	My home burned down.
9	I was falsely accused of a betrayal or crime.
10	I was deeply humiliated by a family member, friend, or lover.
11	I let someone take the blame for something terrible that I did.
12	I have a fear of heights.

LOOSE ENDS

What did you leave unfinished in your past life that still haunts you?

TABLE 12: LOOSE ENDS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	LOOSE END
1	I never finished high school or my college degree.
2	I was about to open a restaurant or other business.
3	I didn't finish writing my novel.
4	A family member, friend, or lover recently died, but I couldn't say my goodbyes.
5	I was on the verge of inventing or discovering something.
6	I made a promise that I might no longer be able to fulfill.
7	My collection was almost complete.
8	I was about to perform for the first time when the collapse happened.
9	I wanted to dump my partner, but...
10	I was just about to buy or finish renovating my home.
11	I never sent that letter to a family member, friend, or loved one.
12	I never got to travel to my dream destination.

REGRETS

What did you do or fail to do that left an emotional scar? Again, this is about your life *before* entering the World Dungeon. We all know that ultimately, your greatest regret is going to be descending that first stairwell... and maybe eating that spicy bean burrito the night before.

TABLE 13: REGRETS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	REGRET
1	I didn't ask them to marry me.
2	I turned down the perfect job.
3	I stayed quiet when I shouldn't have.
4	I chose my own safety when I should have leapt into action.
5	I never said goodbye.
6	I spent way too much time on something pointless.
7	I did something illegal, immoral, and probably both.
8	I lied to avoid an event important to those close to me.
9	I kept a secret that hurt someone badly.
10	I didn't apologize for something terrible that I did.
11	I abandoned someone when they needed me the most.
12	I trusted the wrong people.

STEP 10: DETERMINE STARTING STUFF

You didn't get a warning when the collapse happened. No sirens, no countdown, no helpful flyers explaining what to pack for the end of the world. When you entered the dungeon, you brought whatever happened to be on you at the time, for better or, more likely, worse:

- A set of clothes (which you are wearing).
- One weapon from your starting combat Skill, or no weapon if you want to focus on unarmed combat.
- One interesting or useful item (which can be a secondary weapon if you have a combat Skill from your other backgrounds).
- Weird stuff (get creative).

What counts as interesting, useful, or weird? Some people walk around with a bag full of oddly specific supplies that suddenly seem very valuable in a post-apocalyptic nightmare. Others have nothing but an empty wallet and little chance of surviving.

You and your GM may need to negotiate exactly what makes sense. Use the choices made during the other parts of character creation to help you determine what sort of equipment you would have been carrying.

Below are examples of starting equipment sets:

ATHLETE

- **Clothing:** Jogging attire
- **Weapon:** Barbell (Club)
- **Item:** Headphones, music player
- **Weird Stuff:** A 3-pack of condoms

GAMING GEEK

- **Clothing:** T-shirt, hoodie, and jeans
- **Weapon:** Boffer sword (Longsword, but using d4 base damage dice)
- **Item:** Game book or novel
- **Weird Stuff:** A pack of 12 googly eyes and a single Lego minifig

MILITANT

- **Clothing:** Military fatigues
- **Weapon:** Handgun
- **Item:** 2 snack bars
- **Weird Stuff:** A morale patch that reads, "No Plan Survives First Contact"

OUTDOORSY

- **Clothing:** Apparel appropriate for your location's climate and an orange safety jacket
- **Weapon:** Bow and arrow
- **Item:** Lighter
- **Weird Stuff:** A duck call on a leather cord

You can write down your clothing in the slots provided if you want, but it's not necessary. You should look for a new wardrobe very quickly because



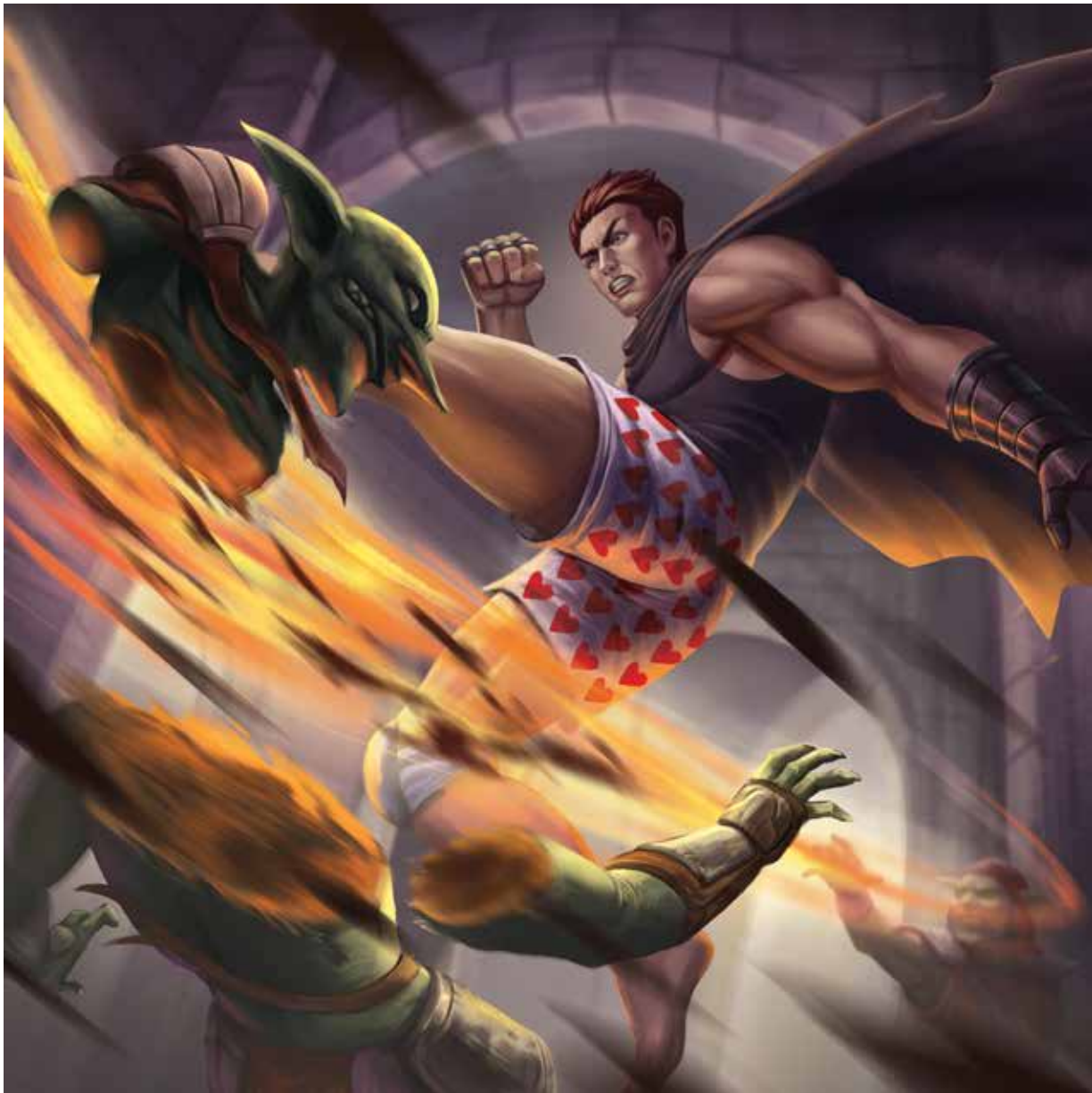
nonmagical outfits don't survive long in the dungeon. If you're holding anything, especially a weapon, write that in the "Hand/Holding" slot. The rest of your stuff goes into your Hotlist on p. 2 of your character sheet or your Inventory on p. 4.

GOOD LUCK! TRY NOT TO DIE.

With that, you have everything you need to begin your crawl in the World Dungeon. You little ones grow up so fast...

To give yourself the best chance of survival, get to know your Skills and look for other useful ones that you can attempt untrained so you might get them to Rank 1 on the Tutorial Floors (see *Checks Without Skill Ranks* in *Rules for Survival*, p. 12)

Now start exploring and be entertaining while kicking some serious dungeon ass. Your whole world is counting on you... literally.



SKILLS

Skills are the heart of the *Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game*. You make Skill Checks to do most things and gain upgrades from Ranking up Skills.

Each Skill entry follows a consistent format:

The header is the name that tells you exactly what it's called—hopefully something that sounds impressive when shouted aloud.

Under the header is a list of keywords identifying the Stat Mod you add to the Skill Check, if any, and any special traits tied to the Skill.

The description explains what the Skill actually does, which I recommend you read before attempting it. On average, 35.71% of deaths in past Crawls are attributable to illiteracy. The description may contain additional keywords like “AI Favor” and “Limitations,” which vary by the Skill type.

Finally, the entry teases you with upgrade benefits if you train it to higher Ranks, as if you need more incentive to avoid your leg being ripped off by a giant crab, only to wake up two floors later to discover it grew an eyeball and a mouth and is licking your face off in anger at being replaced by a prosthetic.

SKILL CHECKS

Skill Checks are either Opposed or Unopposed, depending on what you are up against (see *Rules*, pp. 13–14). Roll 1d20, add your Skill's Rank, and add your associated Stat Mod. If the total matches or exceeds the Difficulty of the check, the outcome is at least a Standard Success but could grant even better effects if you significantly exceed the Difficulty.

Your GM determines the Difficulty for a check, so they're the one who needs to know the exact type of Skill Check you're making. They won't share the Difficulty with you, only informing you of the outcome. Don't worry, System AIs don't cheat or lie; we always fully believe what we tell you.

But if you *must* know every detail (good for you, boring for viewers), Opposed Skills make checks against a specific antagonist, and the Difficulty factors in their Stat Mod. Unopposed Skills make checks against things that don't have a Stat block, like objects or the environment.

The Skill entry's description lists the effects of a Standard Success. Lots of results are possible other than a Standard Success (see *Success and Failure in Rules for Survival*, p. 15). Know that I encourage GMs to get creative when narrating both Successes and Fails.

PASSIVE SKILLS

You don't make Skill Checks to gain the effects of Passive Skills. This makes them easy to use but hard to Rank-up; since you don't make a Skill Check, you can't mark it for a Skill Advancement Check (p. 42). Each Passive Skill entry describes how you can increase its Rank, typically requiring magic gear and training, though some feature other ways.

Using a Passive Skill typically requires an Action like any other Skill type. However, some trigger alongside other Skills at no extra Action cost, like Hand-to-Hand Damage Effects (see p. 24).

You can't use a Passive Skill if you have no Ranks in it (untrained). The easiest way to gain them is via a potion, scroll, or gear. They can also be found in some race and class benefits starting on the Third Floor.

SKILL UPGRADES

As Skills increase in Rank, they grant additional bonuses at Ranks 5, 10, and 15. However, crawlers on the Tutorial Floors only have access to Rank 5 Upgrades. If they manage to get to Rank 10 or higher, they must wait until the Third Floor for the new benefits to kick in.

Upgrades on Attack Skills typically add extra damage dice to the base effect damage, and these always apply even if other parts of the Upgrade are situational. Where an Upgrade increases the range or duration, removes a limitation, or the like, the Upgrade overrides the base effect instead of being in addition to it.

CREATING YOUR OWN SKILLS

The list of Skills in the World Dungeon is endless. Our artificial sky's the limit, folks! Here's the framework in which you can create any Skill you want.

The simplest way is to reuse an existing Skill but reframe its narrative. A Skill like Dumpster Diving could just as easily become Search or Scrounging, just by changing the name and thematic focus while still operating within the same mechanical structure.



Mixing and matching Skill effects and Upgrades is a great way to create weird Skills to really customize your crawler. A Crochet Skill, for instance, might have a custom Upgrade that works like a Utility Skill Upgrade, or it could borrow a Rank 5 Upgrade found on the Dagger Skill. You can invent a new effect or Upgrade following the guideline that the more niche it is, the stronger it can be. If something ends up too strong or too weak, the GM can always patch it later. The system adjusts; so should you.

In play, you'll often find more than one Skill that applies to a situation. Because Skills improve through use, you might choose to attempt a task with a weaker or less optimal Skill just to gain experience with it. This is perfectly normal behavior and occasionally even works out.

Made-up Skills should typically be narrowly focused and should not completely replace or outgun existing Skills... or Actions like Evade. If you want to create an Evade-like Skill, it should perhaps only be useful against a certain attack type (such as Edged Weapons and Ranged Weapons) or come with a significant downside that makes its usage situational.

Evade checks also don't use Ranks, so anything that adds Ranks to a Skill Check that lets you avoid all attacks will instantly be much better than Evading,

and that's a no-no. If you don't spill blood, I won't be happy. That's the whole point!

ATTACK SKILLS (WEAPONS)

"Violence is the most widely understood language in the World Dungeon."

Attack Skills represent your ability to harm, disable, or otherwise make something stop trying to kill you, whether through weapons, fists, or pure destructive intent.

Name: The name of the attack appears as a headline to the entry.

Attack Type: Melee or Ranged. Most attacks are Melee, which have a range of 5 feet (i.e. adjacent). If an attack has a range farther than that, it will be noted in the Range entry below this line. The default Stat Mod used for Melee rolls to hit is STR, while the default Stat Mod for ranged weapon attacks is DEX. If another Stat Mod is used to hit, it will be listed here.

Range: If the attack can hit a target farther than 5 feet away, the maximum distance it can hit will be listed here. If the attack has no range listed, its range is Melee range (adjacent or within 5 feet).

AI Favor: Low-damage weapons grant AI Favor to you if you use such a wimpy attack for a majority of your attacks during a combat that lasts for at least three rounds.

Limitations: Any conditions, requirements, or penalties are listed here. “Requires two hands to wield” is a common limitation, which means both hands must be used to wield the weapon (I’m sure you never would’ve figured that out without this explanation). You can’t hold other things at the same time when attacking.

Cooldown: If the weapon or effect has a cooldown, it will be listed here. Hit or miss, the timer starts. While on cooldown, the weapon or effect cannot be used.

Description: Any notes or descriptions of the Skill are listed here. Make an Attack Skill Check vs. the target’s Evade value, which is: 10 + Dex + the Floor Number.

Base Damage: This is the damage dice the weapon deals with 0–4 Ranks in the Skill. Zero Ranks means using it untrained. The appropriate Stat Mod value is added to the damage. This Mod does not always match the one listed in the Attack Type line, and not every weapon adds a Stat Mod.

Finally, the damage type is listed. The damage type is important if the target has Resistance, Immunity, or Vulnerability to that damage type.

Effects: If there are effects other than damage, they will be listed there.

Upgrades: The Rank 5 Upgrade for the Skill is listed here. Ranks 10 and 15 await you on the Third Floor.

Write your Attack Skills in the “Attacks” section on the front of your character sheet. Fill out the “To Hit” box for your weapons, writing in your “Rank + Stat Mod” values.

Then fill in the “Damage” box. Write in the dice as “1dX,” replacing the “X” with the die type noted in the description. The weapon’s base damage entry will also tell you which Stat Mod (if any) you add to the damage. Use the Effects area to write in short reminders of base effects, Upgrade effects, and AI Favor (if any).

Lastly, write in the Attack Skill name on your “Skills” list. There, you can write in additional notes and mark the advancement box on the far right when you use the Skill. This keeps all your Skills in one place when rolling for Skill Advancement (p. 42). Just remember to update your Rank in the “Attacks” section as well when you advance an Attack Skill.

RANK DAMAGE DICE

One common damage bonus is adding a “Rank damage die” to your damage roll. That die is based on your current Rank in the Attack Skill. It is not part of the base damage of the attack, so it is not doubled on a Critical Hit.

Roll the die that is closest to your Skill Rank without going over (Rank 1 simply grants +1 damage). For example, if you have 7 Ranks, your Rank damage die is 1d6, as that is the closest die without going above 7. Higher Rank dice may come once you hit the Third Floor.

TABLE 14: RANK DAMAGE DICE SCALING

RANK	DAMAGE DICE
1	+1
2–3	+1d2
4–5	+1d4
6–7	+1d6
8–9	+1d8
10–11	+1d10

ATTACK ENTRIES

Attacks are grouped by type, but each weapon entry is a unique Skill. You don’t gain experience for using all edged weapons just because you gave someone a paper cut. The name of the weapon is also the name of the Skill used to wield that weapon.

All Attack Skill Checks are made vs. the target’s Evade value, which sets the Difficulty of the attack.

ANIMAL CRAWLER AND PET STRIKE SKILLS

BACK CLAW

Melee Attack, STR

Base Damage: 1d6 + STR Slashing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 base damage

BITE

Melee Attack, STR

Limitations: The target must have an appendage you can clamp down onto. You taste your victim’s blood. Better hope they’re not poisonous.

Base Damage: 1d8 + STR Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage.



SLICE ATTACK

Melee Attack, DEX

AI Favor: 1

Base Damage: 1d4 + STR Slashing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage

BASHING WEAPON SKILLS

CLUB

Melee Attack, STR

Base Damage: 1d6 + STR Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 base damage

IMPROVISED WEAPONS

Melee Attack, STR

AI Favor: 1

Pick up something and smack someone else with it. That object must weigh at least one pound and can't weigh more than your STR in pounds.

Base Damage: 1d4 + STR Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and you can throw the item (using this Skill) up to a range of Rank × 5 feet.



WARHAMMER

Melee Attack, STR

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield.

Base Damage: 1d10 + STR Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d10 base damage

EDGED WEAPON SKILLS

AXE

Melee Attack, STR

Base Damage: 1d6 + STR Slashing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 base damage

DAGGER

Melee Attack, DEX

AI Favor: 1

Base Damage: 1d4 + STR Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and this attack deals Armor-Piercing damage (ignores DR).

LONGSWORD

Melee Attack, STR

Base Damage: 1d8 + STR Slashing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage

HAND-TO-HAND COMBAT SKILLS

"Striking without a weapon. You have balls, ma'am."

When attacking with a hand-to-hand Attack Skill that has a description stating you can choose a Damage Effect, choose one available Damage Effect before you make the Attack Skill Check. If the attack hits, first roll the base damage dice and then apply the chosen Damage Effect.

If you choose not to use a Damage Effect for a majority of your hand-to-hand attacks during a combat that lasts for at least three rounds, you gain the amount of AI Favor listed in the Skill's entry.

FOOT SOLDIER

Melee Attack, STR

AI Favor: 1 (only if no Damage Effect is used)

Choose the Powerful Strike or Smush Damage Effect (if you wish) before rolling to hit.

Base Damage: 1d4 + STR Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage

NOGGIN NOCKER

It's like a headbutt, only cooler.

Melee Attack, STR

AI Favor: 1 (only if no Damage Effect is used)

Limitations: On Success, you lose 1 Health Bar slot.

Choose the Skullcracker or Powerful Strike Damage Effect (if you wish) before rolling to hit.

Base Damage: 1d4 + CON Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and you don't take any damage from your own attack.

PUGILISM

Philistines call it punching.

Melee Attack, DEX

AI Favor: 2 (only if no Damage Effect is used)

Choose the Iron Punch or Powerful Strike Damage Effect (if you wish) before rolling to hit.

Base Damage: 1d2 + STR Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +2d2 base damage

UNARMED COMBAT

Melee Attack, STR

AI Favor: 1

Limitations: Cannot choose a Damage Effect.

Every crawler starts out with this Skill. This is a mixture of all strikes, so call it what you will when you attack.

Base Damage: 1d4 + STR Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage

WRASSLIN'

Melee Attack, STR

AI Favor: 1 (only if no Damage Effect is used)

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield.

Choose the Choke Out or Toss Damage Effect (if you wish) before rolling to hit.

On Success, the target gains the Held Debuff.

Held foes continue to be Held until they spend an Action to attempt escape (Mobs may use their Move Action). To prevent such an escape, you must use an Action as an Interrupt and succeed in a Wrasslin' STR-Opposed Skill Check.

Base Damage: 1d4 + STR Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You may maintain the Held Debuff at no Action cost if you wish, but your Skill Check to prevent escape is made with Disadvantage.

HAND-TO-HAND DAMAGE EFFECT SKILLS

Hand-to-hand Damage Effects are a special kind of Passive Skill that can be added to certain hand-to-hand Skills to enhance or modify the attack. If the attack succeeds, the chosen Damage Effect applies as well. If the attack Fails, the Damage Effect does nothing but still goes on cooldown (if there is one).

When you make an attack that adds a Damage Effect, place a mark for later Skill Advancement (p. 42) in either the Attack Skill or the Damage Effect, not both.

CHOKE OUT

Wrasslin' Damage Effect, Passive

If the target is at 10% HB or less, you deal ×2 the total damage.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Choke Out activates at 20% HB or less.

IRON PUNCH

Pugilism Damage Effect, Passive

You deal +1d2 base damage.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Add 1 Rank damage die.



POWERFUL STRIKE

Foot Soldier, Noggin Nocker, or Pugilism Damage Effect, Passive

Cooldown: 30 hours

Multiply your base damage dice result by your Rank in this Skill, then add your modifiers and buffs.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The cooldown is 10 hours.

SKULLCRACKER

Noggin Nocker Damage Effect, Passive

If the target is the same size as you, you deal +1d4 base damage.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage if target is the same size as you.

SMUSH

Foot Soldier Damage Effect, Passive

Limitations: You can only apply this Damage Effect to targets with 20% HB or less.

Cooldown: Once per round.

You deal ×2 the total damage.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Smush activates at 30% HB or less and deals ×3 the total damage.

TOSS

Wrasslin' Damage Effect, Passive

You deal +1d8 base damage + STR Bludgeoning, end the Held Debuff, and throw the target 5 feet for every five Ranks (minimum 5 feet) you have in this Skill. You can only Toss foes of a smaller size than you.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can Toss foes up to your own size or smaller.

RANGED WEAPON SKILLS

"Distance creates confidence. The dungeon specializes in removing both."

Ranged Skills allow you to strike targets from a distance, hopefully before they can get into range to attack you—you filthy camper. All ranged weapons use your DEX to hit, and some add your STR to the damage.

BOW

Ranged Attack, DEX

Range: 100 feet

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield. Each attack requires proper ammunition.

Base Damage: 1d6 + STR Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 base damage

CROSSBOW

Ranged Attack, DEX

Range: 50 feet

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield. Each attack requires proper ammunition.

Cooldown: Once per round.

Base Damage: 1d8 Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage



HANDGUN

Ranged Attack, DEX

Range: 150 feet

Limitations: Each attack requires proper ammunition. Spend one Action to reload after a Major Fail or worse.

Base Damage: 1d8 Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage

JAVELIN

Ranged Attack, DEX

Range: 40 feet

Base Damage: 1d8 + STR Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage

SHOTGUN

Ranged Attack, DEX

Range: 30 feet

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield. Each attack requires proper ammunition. Spend one Action to reload after a Major Fail or worse.

Base Damage: 1d10 Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d10 base damage

SHURIKEN

Ranged Attack, DEX

Range: 30 feet

AI Favor: 1

Base Damage: 1d4 + STR Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and the range is 40 feet.

SLINGSHOT

Ranged Attack, DEX

Range: 30 feet

AI Favor: 2

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield.

Base Damage: 1d2 + STR Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d2 base damage, and its range increases by your Strength score in feet.

REACH WEAPON SKILLS

"Keep your foes an arm's length away. For best results, remove their arms entirely."

Reach weapons allow you to make melee attacks against foes up to 10 feet away but not through occupied spaces. You may attack diagonally through the junction of two spaces as long as at least one of those spaces is unoccupied.

POLEARM

Melee Attack, STR

Range: 10 feet

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield.

Base Damage: 1d8 + STR Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage

QUARTERSTAFF

Melee Attack, STR

Range: 10 feet

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield.

Base Damage: 1d6 + STR Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 base damage

EXPLOSIVES SKILLS

"I must admit, I like it when you blow stuff up. I like it a lot."

For handling explosives, see *Explosives Handling*, *Goblin Explosives*, and *Incendiary Device Handling* in Utility Skills (below). These Skills will also be useful for crafting your own explosives once you have access to a Sapper's Table on the Fourth or later Floors.

Explosives found on the Tutorial Floors are the "light and throw" variety instead of traps and time bombs. See the Throwing Skill (p. 35) for targeting, Difficulties, and what happens when you miss your target. Your explosives Skill is not used when attacking with a thrown explosive, but the GM should have you make an Unopposed handling Skill Check before throwing.

Here are the explosives typically found on the first two floors:

- **Standard Explosive—Dynamite:** 1d6 Bludgeoning, 0ft Blast radius +5ft Splash.



- **Goblin Explosive—Dynamite:** 2d6 Bludgeoning damage, 5ft Blast radius + 5ft Splash.
- **Incendiary Device—Carl's Jug O' Boom:** 1d8 Fire damage, 5ft Blast radius + 15ft Splash. Anyone who loses at least 1 HB slot gains the Burned Debuff.

SMOKE

"Smoke is the poor man's invisibility."

Smoke bombs are of the thrown variety on the Tutorial Floors. More varieties will be available on the Third Floor and later floors. See the Throwing Skill (p. 35) for targeting, Difficulties, and what happens when you miss your target. You don't need to make a Skill Check to drop it in your own space.

Smoke is used for concealment, distraction, and confusion. Attacking into or out of smoke is done with Disadvantage (see *Mobs Advantage and Disadvantage in Rules*, p. 14).

- **Goblin Smoke Bomb:** Creates a multicolor smoke cloud that reaches 30 feet in each direction from the point of impact, with a maximum duration of 3 minutes. However, even a slight breeze will dissipate it in 1 minute.

UTILITY SKILLS

"Creative problem-solving is encouraged. Especially if the solution explodes."

Utility Skills help crawlers survive, adapt, and solve problems that can't be fixed by hitting them until they stop moving.

Checks that are labeled as Unopposed can, at the GM's discretion, become Opposed if something is actively working against you. For example, you're trying to swim the rapids, and some dipshit is throwing fishing nets at you. Cut it out, Cletus! Or I'm gonna tell Mom on you!

AIMING

Passive

Limitations: This Skill is used only in conjunction with Ranged attacks. Mark this Skill for Advancement only when applying its Ranks to such an attack.

You are skilled at targeting vital body parts to deal additional damage.

When making a Ranged attack, you can add your Ranks in this Skill to your Attack Skill Check if you

choose to make the Check with Disadvantage.

On Success, add 1d4 to the damage.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 damage

AMBUSH

Intelligence

You are skilled at popping up out of nowhere. When a Mob is moving toward you, even if they are aware of your general presence, make an INT-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success, you gain a surprise Action against the Mob before combat starts. As an unseen attacker, you attack with Advantage.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: If you attack with your surprise Action, add an Ambush Rank damage die to your surprise attack damage.

ANIMAL HANDLING

Charisma

You are skilled in calming, befriending, and guiding animals. Make an INT-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success, the animal is friendly enough to avoid attacking you.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Choose an animal type to specialize in. You have Advantage on your Animal Handling Skill Checks against that animal type.

CATCHER

Passive, Interrupt

When a Successful direct (non-Area) attack is about to damage an ally, you leap in and take the damage instead. You must be adjacent to that ally but can take a 10ft Step before using this Skill to get into position.

You take the damage. You can't use Evade to negate damage dealt to you this way.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You've learned how to take hits. You gain +5 DR against damage taken when using this Skill.

CHOPPER PILOT

Dexterity

Known as a motorcycle in most parts of the world—and in the World Dungeon.

Limitations: You suffer Disadvantage on Attack Skill Checks made while Piloting and cannot attack with a weapon that requires two hands.

You don't need to use this Skill if you're cruising through a town, but if you're racing, chasing, showing off, or trying to pop a wheelie, this is the Skill you want.

If you're doing something wild or trying to avoid becoming a skid mark on the highway, make an Unopposed Skill Check. Depending on how extreme the circumstances are, the GM may apply Advantage or Disadvantage to the check.

On Success, you are able to stay upright while performing your crazy maneuvers.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your chopper has +5 Move.

CLIMBING

Strength

Limitations: If you attack while Climbing, you suffer Disadvantage on those checks.

You don't need to use this Skill if you're climbing up a narrow flight of stairs. Probably not even when you're fully roped in and tethered to other climbers. But if you're racing, chasing, rappelling from a burning building, or doing something dangerous during a climb, this is the Skill you want.

Make an Unopposed Skill Check every minute, not every round. Depending on how extreme the circumstances are, the GM may apply Advantage (previously already climbed it, etc.) or Disadvantage (no ropes, etc.) to the check.

On Success, you are safe in your climb and make progress. See *Special Forms of Movement* in *Rules for Survival*, p. 24, if the distance moved is important.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Make a check every 5 minutes.

DECEPTION

Charisma

If you know the truth but want to obscure it, this is the Skill for you. When you lie and try to get away with it, make an INT-Opposed Skill Check. If the creature you're lying to has the Detect Lies Skill, you make this check with Disadvantage.

On Success, they believe you!

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can use this Skill while gambling.

DETECT LIES

Intelligence

You have an incredible bullshit detector. If you believe someone is trying to lie to you, you can make a CHA-Opposed Skill Check. If they possess the Deception Skill, you make this check with Disadvantage.

On Success, you sense if they're lying, but if they believe they're telling the truth, you sense they're telling the truth.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: When you Fail, you still can't detect the lie, but you can ignore the additional effects of a Major Fail or worse.

DETECT TRAP

Intelligence

When you suspect a room, door, chest, or other object has an active trap, this is the Skill you want. Make an Unopposed Skill Check. Roll with Disadvantage when using this Skill to scan an entire room or while moving.

On Success, you are alerted to the presence of a non-magic trap, which typically allows you to avoid triggering it.

On Fail, you sense nothing, and a trap may or may not be present.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can detect magical traps.

DETERMINE VALUE

Passive

Limitations: Ranks in this Skill only increase by magical means.

You can sort your HUD's Inventory by item value. The actual gold value is not displayed.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your Inventory is tabbed to sort your items by type, and it includes a history tab that tracks your item usage and any former owners of an item.



DODGE

Passive

Limitations: Mark the Skill for Advancement when Evading until you reach Rank 5. After that, its Rank may only be raised via magical bonuses or training.

You gain a +1 Evade Buff.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Gain a +1 Evade Buff, and you may Step an additional 5ft when you perform the Evade Action.

DRIVING

Dexterity

Limitations: If you attack while Driving, you suffer Disadvantage on those checks.

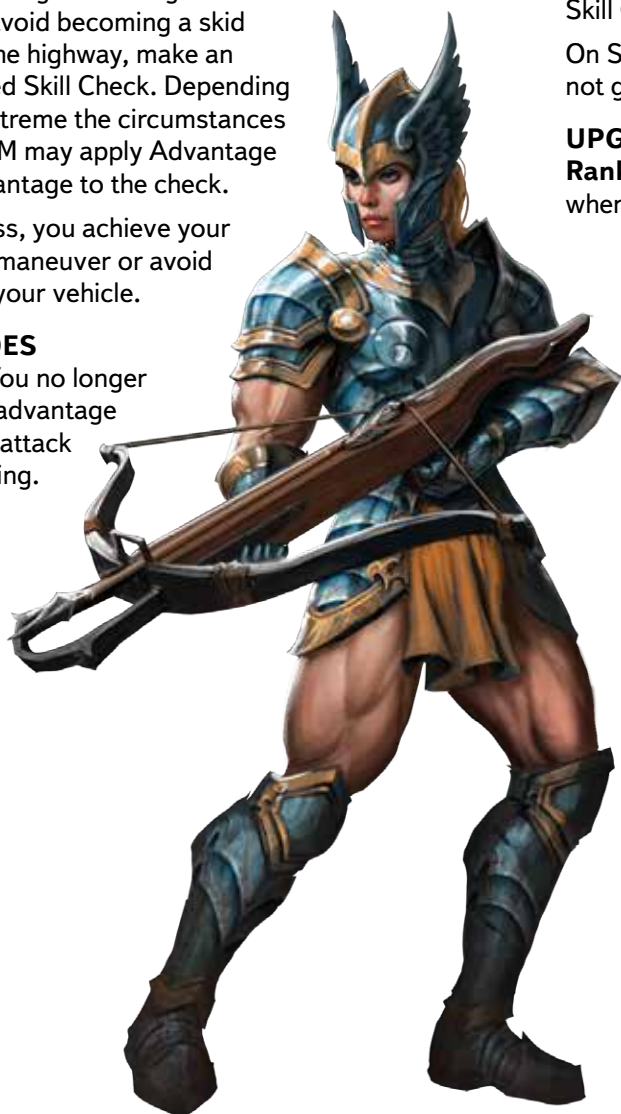
You don't need to use this Skill if you're casually driving down the road to pick up a quart of milk, but if you're racing, chasing, showing off, or doing something dangerous in a vehicle, this is the Skill you want.

If you're doing something wild or trying to avoid becoming a skid mark on the highway, make an Unopposed Skill Check. Depending on how extreme the circumstances are, the GM may apply Advantage or Disadvantage to the check.

On Success, you achieve your daredevil maneuver or avoid wrecking your vehicle.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You no longer suffer Disadvantage when you attack while Driving.



DUMPSTER DIVING

Intelligence

Known as scrounging in some parts of the world.

This Skill bolsters your ability to search the clutter within the dungeon to find interesting bits of rubbish and maybe something useful. Using this Skill takes 1 hour and can only be performed once per 50ft-square area. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you find what you were looking for or an interesting item, determined by the GM.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You also find 1 Rank damage die's-worth of Misc. Junk.

ENDURANCE

Constitution

Use this Skill to prevent fatigue while grinding, walking long distances (measured in miles), or other extended strenuous activities. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you may continue the activity and do not gain the Fatigued Debuff.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can ignore the effects of a Major Fail when making these checks.



ENGINEERING

Intelligence

Limitations: Cannot create vehicles. Vehicle creation requires a workbench, and their creation rules are covered in the *Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Core Rulebook*.

This Skill is used to design and build things with moving parts, fluids, or chemicals wholly out of Misc. Junk with no inherent bonuses, though they may have situational bonuses. Examples include a watch, a water pump, or bullets. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you create the item.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Choose a mundane item type to specialize in. You have Advantage when creating an item of that type.

ESCAPE ARTIST

Dexterity

Holy Houdini! While anyone can use Dexterity to try to wiggle out of restraints or a hold, you're especially skilled at the art of escape. When you try to escape from bonds or being Held, you can use this Skill. When trying to escape bonds, make an Unopposed Skill Check.

To escape being Held, make a STR-Opposed Skill Check. Based on the complexity or simplicity of what binds you, the GM may have you make the check with Advantage or Disadvantage.

On Success, you escape your bonds or the creature holding you.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can escape your bonds, and no one sees you do it. If you escape being Held, you can then take a Step (also unseen).

EXPLOSIVES HANDLING

Intelligence

For making Attack Skill Checks with explosives, see Throwing (p. 35).

Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you are able to safely handle standard explosive devices.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You are able to determine the type, status, and raw materials of explosives you handle.

FABRICATE

Intelligence

Limitations: Cannot create things with moving parts, fluids, or chemicals.

Use this Skill to make generic, mundane items with no inherent bonuses wholly out of Misc. Junk, but your GM can give them situational bonuses. Examples include a ladder, a 50ft rope, or a ceramic pot to store napalm. For items with moving parts, see the Engineering Skill above instead. You can find additional details on crafting in *Rules for Survival* (p. 50). Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you create the item.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Choose a mundane item to specialize in. You have Advantage when creating that item.

FIND CRAWLER

Passive

Limitations: Ranks in this Skill only increase by magical means.

Your HUD displays other crawlers within 1,000 feet of you. They are designated with a blue dot.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The area in which you can detect other crawlers increases to 5 miles.

FIRST AID

Intelligence

Limitations: After you treat someone, you can't treat them again until they complete a short or long rest.

Give minor medical aid to yourself or someone else. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, the patient regains 1 HB slot. Each higher degree of Success heals an additional HB slot.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: If you spend 5 minutes, the patient also heals a Minor Injury Debuff.

GOBLIN EXPLOSIVES

Intelligence

For making Attack Skill Checks with explosives, see Throwing (p. 35).

Make an Unopposed Skill Check. Goblin Explosives are so unstable that Critical Fails occur on a Natural 1–4.

On Success, you safely use Goblin Explosive devices.



UPGRADES

Rank 5: Critical Fail occurs on a Natural 3 or less. You are able to determine the type, status, and raw materials of Goblin Explosives you handle.

GOOD FIRST IMPRESSION

Charisma

Limitations: This Skill doesn't work on crawlers, Bosses, or Elites. You can only make a Skill Check against individuals, not groups.

When you encounter an NPC or Mob that is not immediately hostile or attacking, make an INT-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success, the Mob approaches with wary curiosity.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: A Mob that is lower level than you won't attack your party unless they are attacked by a member of your party.

HIDE IN SHADOWS

Dexterity

Limitations: To move while avoiding detection, see the Stealth Skill (p. 34).

While in a heavily shadowed area or out of sight, you can stay still and attempt to foil foes' chances to spot you. Make an INT-Opposed Skill Check. If you're hiding behind an object that is larger than you, roll with Advantage.

On Success, you become invisible to Mobs and the HUDs of other crawlers but can still be affected by environmental and Area damage. You become visible if you take an Action that affects another creature or if you're no longer behind cover.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can use this Skill in a dim light without having an object to hide behind.

INCENDIARY DEVICE HANDLING

Intelligence

For making Attack Skill Checks with incendiary devices, see Throwing (p. 35).

Make an Unopposed Skill Check. On Success, you are able to safely handle incendiary devices.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You are able to determine the type, status, and raw materials of incendiary devices you handle.

INTIMIDATE

Strength

You can use this Skill to scare the wits out of a foe. Make a CHA-Opposed Skill Check. If either side has attacked or taken a hostile stance in this encounter, roll with Disadvantage.

On Success, the target gains the Staggered debuff (see *Rules for Survival*, p. 46).

UPGRADES

Rank 5: On Success or greater, until the end of the next round, the target can only use its remaining Actions to move away from you (though it does not need to use its 10ft Step when doing so).



INVESTIGATION

Intelligence

You spend 10 minutes looking at an area or puzzle in front of you and might make heads or tails of it. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

When you take the Look for Clues Action (see *Look for Clues* in *Rules for Survival*, p. 36) spend only one Action to use this Skill.

On Success, you learn something useful.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: If you're familiar with the area you are investigating, you can make the Skill Check with Advantage.

JUMPING

Strength

With a running start of at least 10 feet (made as a 10ft Step with this Action), you leap through the air in an arcing trajectory. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you leap a distance in feet up to your Rank + STR with a height of 1ft.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Add your DEX to the height of your Jump.

LIGHT ON YOUR FEET

Dexterity

Limitations: Usable only by animals

With a running start of at least 10 feet (made as a 10ft Step with this Skill), you leap through the air in an arcing trajectory. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you leap a distance in feet up to your Rank $\times$ 2 with a height equal to your DEX $\times$ 2 in feet.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your distance is Rank $\times$ 3 and your height is DEX $\times$ 3.

LOCKPICKING

Dexterity

Limitations: Roll with Disadvantage if you do not have the proper tools, unless it's a crude lock.

You spend the Floor Number in minutes trying to pick the lock. Make an Unopposed Skill Check (more complex locks may have a higher Difficulty, as determined by the GM). If the lock was created by a named antagonist, this could be an INT-Opposed Skill Check instead.

On Success, you pick the lock!

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You make no noise and leave no trace.

NEGOTIATION

Charisma

Limitations: Does not work on members of your own party. Some items have a minimum price.

You spend 5 minutes haggling over the price of items or negotiating to get what you want through compromise. Typically, haggling is done with an NPC merchant when you're buying or selling items. If you haggle with other entities, you do so with Disadvantage. Make an INT-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success, you increase or decrease the price 10% in your favor. If you're not haggling, the opponent tentatively agrees to your terms.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your party members can also buy or sell at your newly-negotiated price.

PERCEPTION

Intelligence

You concentrate your senses to pick out details about your environment that others might miss. Make an Unopposed Skill Check, though the GM will likely adjust the Difficulty based on the lighting, how cluttered the area is, how quickly an event occurs, and other such circumstances.

Also use Perception when you make a Look for Clues Action (see *Look for Clues* in *Rules for Survival*, p. 36).

On Success, you notice something. It could be important; it might not be.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Halve the penalty for cluttered areas.

PERFORMANCE

Charisma

Whether you're acting, dancing, playing an instrument, singing, or delivering slam poetry, use this Skill when you want to electrify an audience. Choose a type of performance to specialize in as your starting type, be it comedy, guitar, screamo, or reciting the collected works of Alan Ginsberg. Make an Unopposed Skill Check to determine the audience reaction. If you are competing against other performers, add the top rival's CHA to the Difficulty.

On Success, you command the stage. The audience is entertained.



UPGRADES

Rank 5: Choose an additional type of performance to specialize in.

PERSUASION

Charisma

You have a knack for getting others to see things your way. You typically need about 10 minutes of shmoozing in a safe environment to make a check with this Skill, and you may suffer Disadvantage if the request is risky, inconvenient, or untoward. Make an INT-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success, you convince the target to follow your suggestion if it isn't too costly for them, too dangerous, or against their nature.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: They'll follow your suggestion as long as it isn't too costly for them.

REGENERATION

Passive

If your Rank in this Skill is equal to or greater than your CON, you heal 1 HB slot at the start of each round (or every 10 seconds outside of combat). If not, you heal 1 HB slot every other round (or every 20 seconds outside of combat).

UPGRADES

Rank 5: After 5 minutes, any Minor Injury Debuff you suffer from ends. After 10 minutes, any Major Injury Debuff you suffer from ends.

REPAIR

Intelligence

Limitations: For basic repairs to items with no moving parts, magical or not.

After spending 2 hours, you can repair most simple items that are broken or damaged but not destroyed. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you repair the item.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can make repairs to things with moving parts.

RUNNING

Dexterity

Limitations: For short bursts of running. For extended runs, use Endurance instead (p. 29).

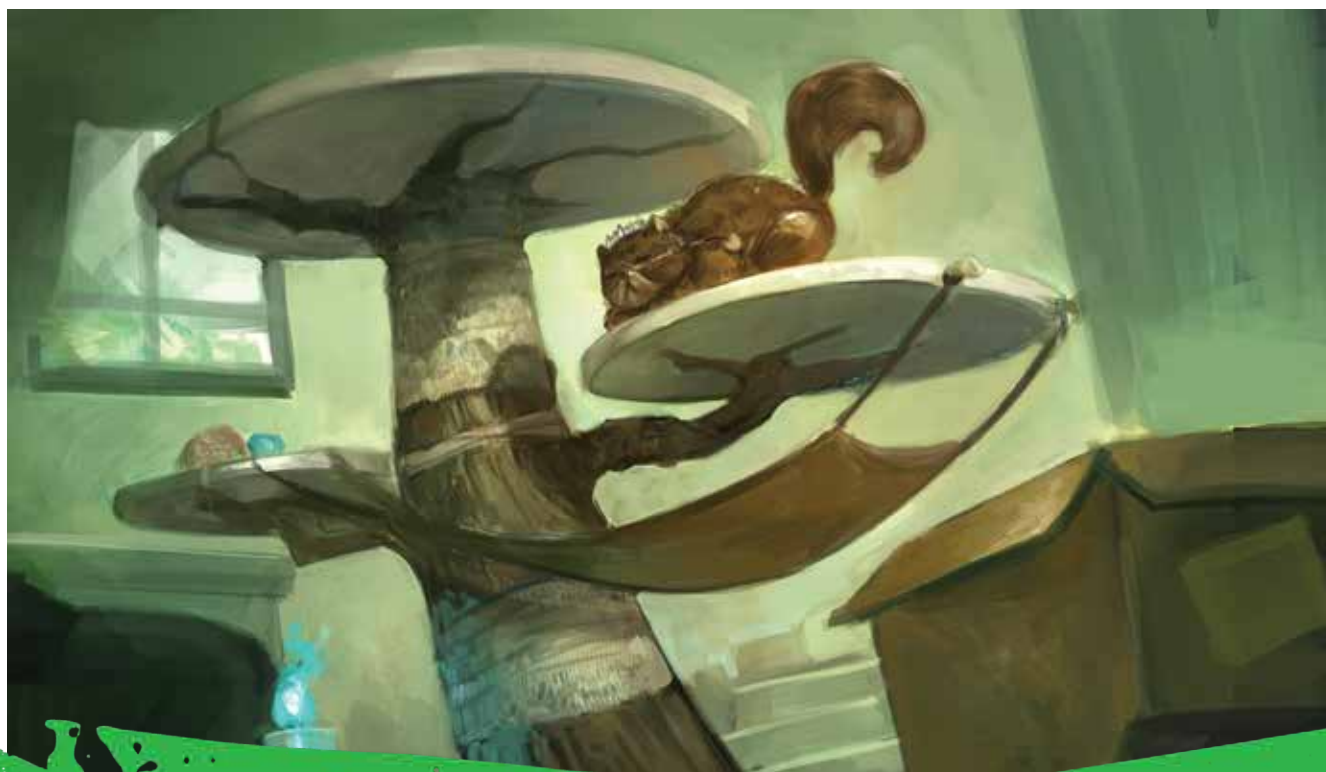
You don't need to use this Skill if you're running down a hallway to attack some Mobs. But if you're racing, chasing, or need to get away from a ticking time bomb, this is the Skill you want. See *Racing and Chasing in Rules for Survival* (p. 26).

Make an Unopposed Skill Check every minute, not every round. Add 1 to your result for every 10ft of Move you have.

On Success, you succeed in the run.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Make a check every 2 minutes. You have +5ft Move.



SALVAGE

Intelligence

Limitations: Salvage cannot be used with explosive devices.

Salvage is the art of collecting useful items from things you have deconstructed or failed to properly craft. Salvaging usually takes 1 hour to accomplish. At the end of that time, make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you recover half of the important raw materials.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your Salvage checks take 30 minutes.

SLEIGHT OF HAND

Dexterity

Limitations: Items you manipulate must be smaller than the size of your hand. You cannot access others' Inventories or Hotlists.

You've learned to manipulate small objects without being spotted. Great for shoplifting. Make an INT-Opposed Skill Check. If someone's Perception is a higher Rank than your Sleight of Hand, you have Disadvantage.

On Success, you maneuver the item without being noticed.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You may attempt to pick the pockets of NPCs and Mobs.

STEALTH

Dexterity

Limitations: You must be out of sight of all foes to begin this check.

Use this Skill if you want to move undetected or surprise a Mob. Make an INT-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success before combat starts, you are unnoticed and gain 1 non-Attack Action. Don't forget to take your 10ft Step!

On Success in a non-combat situation, you remain unnoticed and can perform a Move action with a 10ft Step as part of this check.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your surprise Action can be an attack with Advantage.

STREETWISE

Charisma

Use this Skill in populated areas to learn or spread rumors, avoid attracting too much attention, gain access to less-than-legal items, and the like. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you navigate a town without attracting attention, deal with a criminal network, identify an informal power structure, or gain the information you're seeking.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You also hear an additional rumor, as determined by the GM.

SURVIVAL

Constitution

You know how to survive in dangerous, often remote places for long periods of time with only the meager food and water you can rustle up. When traveling through such areas, make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you survive the perils of the conditions unscathed. On a standard Fail, you suffer the effects of hunger and/or thirst (see *Rules for Survival*, p. 28).

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You do not suffer additional damage from a Critical Fail.

SWIMMING

Strength

Limitations: After 1 minute of Swimming (Success or Fail) or immediately on a Major Fail or worse, gain the Fatigued Debuff.

Use this Skill when there are consequences for not swimming strongly or well rather than when you're taking a casual swim. For instance, if you're racing for your life or swimming against a strong current. In these cases, make an Unopposed Skill Check every 30 seconds.

On Success, you swim well despite the danger. For swimming during combat, see *Special Forms of Movement* in *Rules for Survival*, p. 24.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: After 2 minutes of Swimming (Success or Fail), gain the Fatigued Debuff.



TACTICS

Intelligence

Limitations: A crawler may attempt this Skill Check only once per combat.

Your tactical mind and directions can spur your allies to victory. Choose one of the following combat disciplines: Attack, Damage, or Evade, and then make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you and each member of your party gain a +1 bonus to checks for the chosen discipline. Increase the bonus by +1 for each higher degree of Success.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: If you observe the foes and battlefield for at least 5 minutes prior to combat, roll this Skill Check with Advantage.

TAUNT

Charisma, Interrupt

With a shout, some choice words, and maybe an obscene hand gesture, you attempt to draw the ire of enemies within 30 feet of you. After seeing where the Mob attacks are headed, make an INT-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success, Taunt *one* attack of your choosing away from any target of your choosing and onto you. Higher degrees of Success allow you to Taunt additional attacks onto you.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You may make a free Evade check against each Taunted attack (roll separately vs. each attack as usual). Then you may still spend an Action to Evade other attacks and reroll any Fails from your free Evades.

THROWING

Strength

This Skill is used for passing the pigskin with your pops or throwing dynamite (potentially also at your pops).

You can Throw an object that weighs up to your STR in pounds at a distance of up to your STR × 10 feet. If you want to Throw a heavier or bulkier item (up to the GM's discretion), you do so with Disadvantage.

To hit a general target area, make an Unopposed Skill Check.

To hit a foe with an object, make an Attack Skill Check vs. the target's Evade.

On Success, you hit the target.

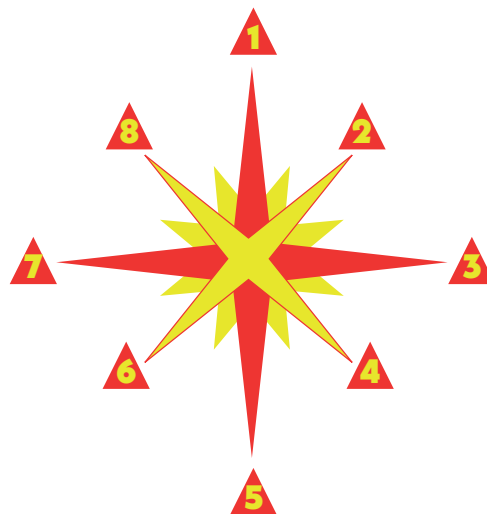
On Fail, roll 1d8 for direction (see Figure 1). The

amount the Skill Check missed by is the distance away in feet it lands.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You have Advantage when Throwing to a target who wants to catch what you are selling.

FIGURE 1: DIRECTION ON A D8



TRACKING

Intelligence

Use this Skill to find and follow tracks. When searching for or attempting to follow tracks, make an Unopposed Skill Check. Factors such as how long ago the tracks were made, the ground conditions, and whether other tracks or marks obscure them may influence the check. Once you find tracks, you must make another Tracking check every 15 minutes to continue following them.

On Success, you either find the tracks or continue following them.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can follow found tracks for 30 minutes before making a new check.

SPELL SKILLS

“Spellcasting is highly encouraged. Responsibility is optional.”

Spells are the strange, dangerous, and occasionally irresponsible way crawlers bend reality. Some Spells heal wounds or reshape the battlefield, and others exist primarily to make something stop moving—permanently. Spells *cannot* be attempted untrained except via a scroll.

Every Spell listed in this section follows the same core rules for things like casting, targeting, and spending Mana. Spell listings include a variety of terms or fields associated with them, including:

Name: The name of the Spell appears as a headline to the entry.

Type: Whether the Spell is an Attack or Passive is noted under the flavor text. The type of damage delivered from Attack Spells is also listed here for quick reference.

Mana Cost: The Mana cost to cast the Spell.

Range: The range of the Spell. Melee means 5ft (adjacent).

Duration: Some Spells are not instantaneous. Those with lasting effects have the duration listed here. Spells that last for combat rounds end during Combat Step 5: Clean Up (see *Rules for Survival*, p. 37).

AI Favor: Low-damage Spells grant AI Favor to you if you use such a wimpy attack for a majority of your attacks during a combat that lasts for at least three rounds.

Limitations: If there are conditions, requirements, or exclusions, they go here.

Cooldown: If the Spell has a cooldown, it is listed here. You can’t cast the Spell during its cooldown.

Description: Any notes or descriptions of the general effect seen when you cast the Spell are listed here. If the Spell requires a Spell Skill Check, that is also provided here.

Base Damage: This is the damage the Spell deals with 1–4 Ranks in the Spell. You add your INT to the base damage. The damage type is listed here as well.

Upgrades: These are bonuses you gain when you reach the listed Rank in the Spell. The first entry of each benefit adds a damage die of the same type to the base damage of the Spell. Additional damage dice and effects are also listed here.

SPELLS IN YOUR HOTLIST

Don’t forget that Spells need to be in your Hotlist to cast them in combat or other stressful situations. Write down the specific combat text for your Spell in the “Attacks” section on the front of your character sheet. When you write a Spell on your Hotlist, you need only list additional notes like the Mana cost and Range of the Spell.

Attack Spells require you to make an Attack Skill Check vs. the target’s Evade. Spells that don’t require a check to be made when cast (non-attack Spells) are tagged as Passive and simply happen, but those are not marked for Skill Advancement (p. 42) when used. Instead, their Ranks must be raised via magical means or training.

ASTRAL PAW (ASTRAL HAND, ASTRAL CLAW)

“You have summoned an astral paw. Yes, just the paw. Budget constraints.”

Passive

Mana Cost: 12

Range: 30 feet

Duration: Until the end of combat or 5 minutes

You conjure a spectral hand, paw, or claw, looking much like your own. You can use this astral appendage to manipulate objects up to 30ft away by spending an Action. You can use the Astral Paw to make Skill Checks but suffer Disadvantage due to a lack of fine control.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your Pugilism and Slice Attacks with the Paw add 1 Astral Paw Rank damage die.

CONFUSING FOG

“Visibility reduced. Decision-making questionable.”

Passive

Mana Cost: 6

Range: 40 feet

Duration: Until the end of two full rounds of combat or 20 seconds

Cooldown: 15 minutes

You create a billowing cloud of fog that you, your party members, and friendly NPCs can see through, but it obscures the area from Mobs, making it more difficult for them to attack you. Mobs attack with Disadvantage (see *Mob Advantage and Disadvantage* in *Rules for Survival*, p. 14) against targets in the fog.

This fog fills a 25 by 25ft area. Smart Mobs may attempt to move the combat out of the fog if able.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The fog fills a 50 by 50ft area, and its duration is 1 minute.



DIRT CLOD

"You have weaponized dirt."

Attack, Bludgeoning

Mana Cost: 1

Range: 100 feet

AI Favor: 2

You hurl a magical clod of dirt, leaving dirt and pebbles strewn about near the target.

Base Damage: 1d2 + INT Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +2d2 base damage

DRAIN LIFE

"Organic tether deployed. Try not to think about where it's been."

Attack, Necrotic

Mana Cost: 14

Range: 30 feet

For a brief instant, you create a disgusting blood vein that reaches out and wraps itself around your target.

Base Damage: 1d6 + INT Necrotic

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 base damage, and if the target loses at least 3 HB slots, you heal 1 HB slot.

FIREBALL

"It almost reluctantly meanders toward you. Then your world explodes."

Attack, Fire, Area of Effect

Mana Cost: 45

Range: 80 feet

Cooldown: Once per scene

A creeping beach ball-sized sphere of fire emanates from you. Since it moves so slowly, your attack is made with Disadvantage. When the impact zone has been determined, each creature in a 10ft Blast radius takes full damage.

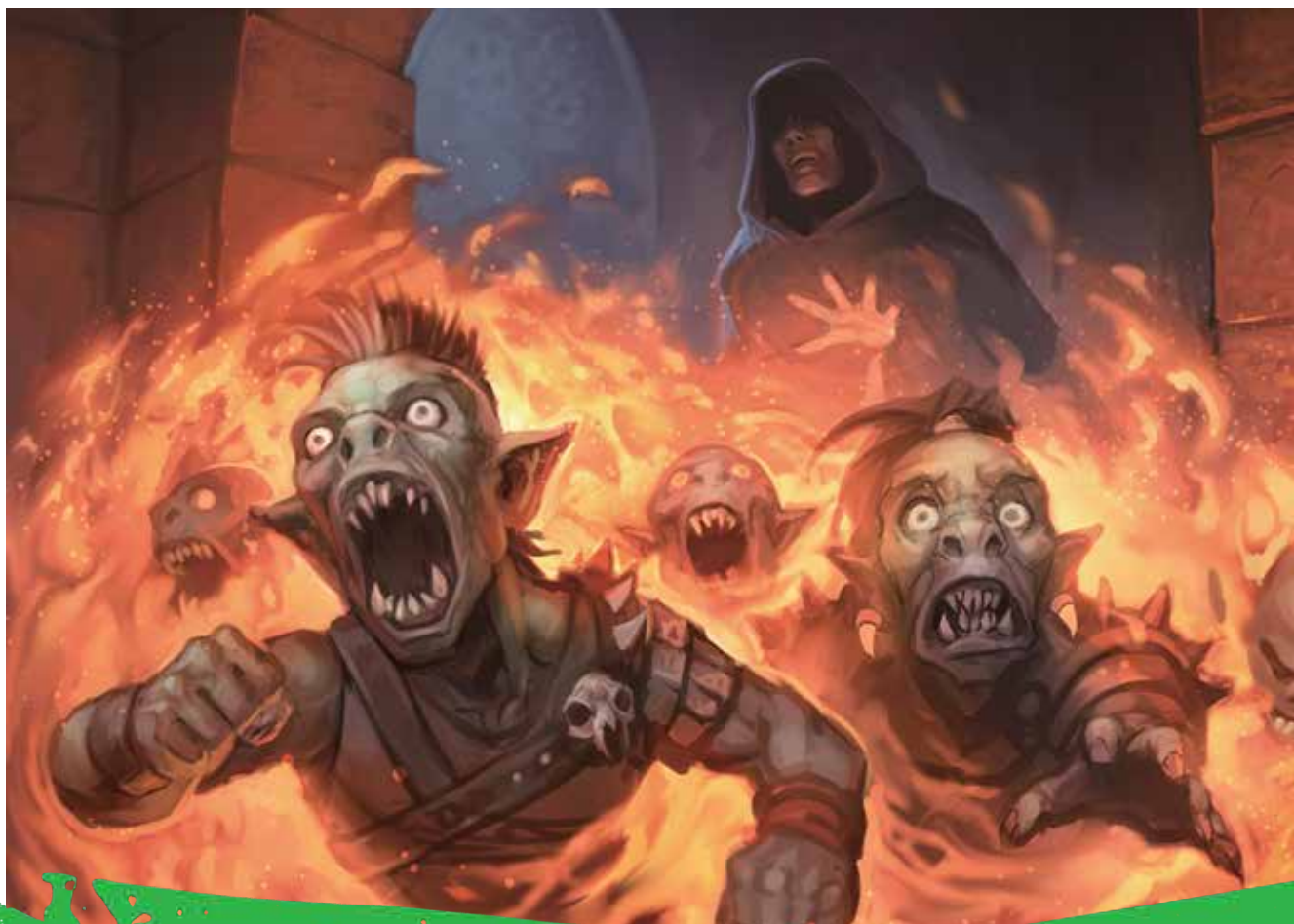
On Fail, roll 1d8 for direction (see Figure 1, p. 35).

The amount the Skill Check missed by is the distance away in feet it impacts.

Base Damage: 1d12 + INT Fire, 10ft Blast radius

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d12 base damage. Those who lose 1 or more HB slots via this attack gain the Burned Debuff.



FIRE FINGERS

"Fire Fingers activated. Try not to make it weird."

Attack, Fire

Mana Cost: 3

Range: Melee

AI Favor: 1

Brilliant flame leaps from your fingers.

Base Damage: 1d4 + INT Fire

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage

FROST SCAR

"Frigid status achieved; relationships may suffer."

Attack, Ice

Mana Cost: 2

Range: Melee

AI Favor: 1

With a slice of your frigid hand, you leave a scar of rime on your target.

Base Damage: 1d4 + INT Ice

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and the target cannot heal themselves in the next combat round.

HEAL

"Congratulations on not dying... yet."

Interrupt, Passive

Mana Cost: 2

Range: Self only

Limitations: Rank 1 maximum

Heal 2 HB slots.

UPGRADES

None

HEAL OTHERS

"Tell me you're a Cleric without..."

Interrupt, Passive

Mana Cost: 6

Range: 30 feet

Limitations: You can't cast this Spell on yourself.

A wave of positive vibes engulfs the target. They heal 1d4 HB slots.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The target heals 1d6 HB slots.

HOLE

"It's a hole. This will absolutely be misused."

Passive

Mana Cost: 12

Range: 10 feet

Duration: Until the end of the combat or 5 minutes.

Limitations: Can't be used on saferoom doors or living things.

You create a temporary cylindrical hole in a surface or material within range, to a depth of 1 inch per Spell Rank and a diameter of 2ft. Anything that can fit in the hole can pass through it if the hole is deep enough to penetrate to the other side of the surface.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can reduce the diameter of the hole to a smaller size when cast.

ICE BLAST

"Hope they brought a jacket."

Attack, Ice

Mana Cost: 9

Range: 40 feet

With the howl of blizzard winds, you let loose a compact pocket of freezing cold and ice.

Base Damage: 1d8 + INT Ice

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage

LIGHTNING BOLT

"Bolt released, viewership spike detected."

Attack, Electric

Mana Cost: 15

Range: 100 feet

With a thunderous clap, you let loose a bolt of lightning.

Base Damage: 1d10 + INT Electric

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d10 base damage

MAGIC MISSILE

"Standard Spell detected. Viewers appreciate the nostalgia."

Attack, Force

Mana Cost: 5

Range: Within your line of sight

AI Favor: 1

From glowing eyes, fingers, or whatever, a streak of pure force shoots out.



Base Damage: 1d4 + INT Force

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and you can cast the Spell at a higher or lower Mana cost.

3 Mana: -4 damage

4 Mana: -2 damage

6 Mana: Add 1 Rank damage die

PROTECTIVE SHELL

"Hope activated. Try not to waste it."

Interrupt, Passive

Mana Cost: None

Range: Self

Duration: 5 seconds (only long enough to push foes away, and protect against a single physical attack)

Cooldown: 30 hours

Limitations: Spell must be imbued onto something you are wearing. The shell cannot be moved by any means.

You create a 10 + INT-foot radius magic shell around yourself and nearby party members.

This shell pushes away all Mobs in its Area, which is

the shell's radius + 5ft. Mobs cannot enter the shell (unless non-corporeal) or physically attack those inside. The shell does not protect against magic effects. Crawlers inside may attack as usual.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Duration is 10 seconds. In addition to knocking enemies away, it protects the occupants from all non-Spell attacks originating from outside the shell until the end of the current combat round.

PUDDLE JUMPER

"Teleportation doesn't suck."

Passive

Mana Cost: 20

Range: Line-of-sight to the destination surface.

Limitation: There is a 10-second delay before the effect takes place.

Cooldown: 5 hours

You and up to 3 party members of your choice teleport to another location. Everyone feels a tingling sensation while waiting for the effect to resolve.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The delay is 2 seconds, and the destination doesn't have to be a surface.



SECOND CHANCE

"Everyone deserves one. Except for Phil. Never Phil."

Passive

Mana Cost: 10

Range: 10 feet

Duration: 1 minute

You raise a Mob with a level lower than your own from the dead. The Mob temporarily becomes your Undead Minion with half of its original HB slots. You spend one Action to command it, then it acts independently with 1 Move Action and 1 other Action (usually an attack) until given new instructions.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The Mob can be up to 5 levels higher than you, and the duration is 5 minutes.

SHIELD

"Enjoy the illusion of safety."

Interrupt, Passive

Mana Cost: 8

Range: Self

Duration: 5 minutes

You are surrounded by a translucent force field that moves with you and reduces non-magic damage you take. The shield has 2 HB slots, each with your CON Mod. When you take damage, reduce these HB slots first. The Spell ends early if the shield loses all its HB slots. You can't heal a shield.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The Shield has 5 HB slots.

SHOCK TREATMENT

"Electrical therapy initiated; consent not required."

Attack, Electric

Mana Cost: 2

Range: 30 feet

AI Favor: 2

Like a deranged emperor, bolts of electricity shoot out from your fingers.

Base Damage: 1d2 + INT Electric

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d2 base damage, and you may choose to afflict the target with the Stunned Debuff instead of dealing damage.

SOUL COLLECTOR

"This soul appears... reusable."

Attack, Necrotic

Mana Cost: 4

Range: 50 feet

AI Favor: 1

With a twist of the hand, you siphon the spirit from your target.

Base Damage: 1d4 + INT Necrotic

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and if this Spell deals the killing blow to a foe of at least half your level, it deals +1 bonus damage until you complete a long rest. This damage bonus is cumulative up to the Spell's Rank.

THUNDERLASH

"Loud noises and bad decisions go hand-in-hand."

Attack, Sonic

Mana Cost: 12

Range: 50 feet

You unleash a whip-like emanation of pure sound which thunders through the air.

Base Damage: 1d10 + INT Sonic

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d10 base damage

TORCH

"Congratulations. You can now see what's trying to kill you."

Passive

Mana Cost: 1

Range: Self

Duration: Until you enter a saferoom or descend to a new floor.

You create a magical orb of light that follows slightly above and behind you. It provides bright light for a 20ft radius and dim light for a 20ft radius past that.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can move the orb up to 20 feet away from you.

UNNECESSARY FORCE

"Excessive force authorized. Paperwork waived."

Attack, Force

Mana Cost: 13

Range: 40 feet

A shockwave akin to that of an A-bomb crashes over your target.

Base Damage: 1d12 + INT Force

UPGRADE

Rank 5: +1d12 base damage

WISP ARMOR

"Empty minds are surprisingly easy to protect."

Passive

Mana Cost: 5

Range: Self

Duration: 5 minutes

Cooldown: 5 minutes

You conjure a protective barrier that reduces all magic damage (typically Spells) down to its Rank 1 base damage (1d + Stat Mod) without any Upgrades or other bonuses. This Spell also makes you immune to mind control.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The duration is 10 minutes.



CRAWLER ADVANCEMENT

You'll increase your Skill Ranks and level rapidly on the World Dungeon's Tutorial Floors. On later floors, it takes more time, training, and grinding to see improvement.

Don't forget to try out some untrained Skills on the Tutorial Floors if you want to gain new Skills (see *Checks Without Skill Ranks* in *Rules for Survival*, p. 12). Or you can stay your boring old self and never grow, never improve. We'll see how that works out for you, won't we?



RANK LIMITS

On Floors 1–5, your Skill Rank is capped at 15. This rule is courtesy of your lovely Borant showrunners, not me. Make sure to convey your appreciation to a Borant Admin if you meet one. Ranks 16+ will feature in a future expansion.

SKILL ADVANCEMENT

Most Skills improve through use. Each Skill on your character sheet has a box in the column on the far right that's labeled with a green checkmark. Whenever you attempt a Skill Check, whether you Succeed or Fail, mark the box if it isn't already marked.

Marked Skills are eligible for a Skill Advancement Check. To make the check, roll 1d20 against your current Skill Rank as the Difficulty. If the result is equal to or higher than your Skill's current Rank, you gain 1 Rank in the Skill, up to a maximum of 15.

As you gain more Ranks in a Skill, it takes longer to improve. At the intervals below, make a Skill Advancement Check for each Skill with a mark.

- If at Rank 4 or lower, roll a Skill Advancement Check at the end of every 2 hours of play.
- If at Rank 5 or higher, roll a Skill Advancement Check at the end of each floor.

After resolving these rolls, erase all marks and start fresh.

Passive Skills don't require a Skill Check to use, and most of them don't receive Advancement marks when used. With a few exceptions, you can only increase Passive Skills via magical means or through race or class benefits.

Hand-to-hand Damage Effects advance separately from their associated Attack Skills. When you use a hand-to-hand attack and a Damage Effect, mark only one or the other, not both.

Whenever you gain levels, simply record your new level on your character sheet. Once you reach the Third Floor, you'll get to increase your Stats and more!



GRINDING

“Repeated violence improves efficiency.”

The Grinding is not only the name of another fucked-up Matt Dinniman novel; here in the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**, it’s also the act of continually brutalizing the lowest-level Mobs you can find to increase your Skill Ranks and occasionally level up.

To grind, you must gain access to a large group of Mobs in a relatively small area or along a path to a destination. There is no risk to you during a typical grind, but there’s also no time for looting Mob corpses.

Instead of making individual Skill Checks during a grind session, it’s treated like a montage as you spend time improving your Skills.

Grinding is measured in hours. Choose the number of hours you wish to grind. Crawlers typically go for up to 5 hours at a time, but seasoned crawlers can push for much longer. For every hour of grinding past 5 hours in a single day, you must make an Unopposed Endurance Skill Check to see if that hour was productive or not. On Fail, that hour was not productive for you (no grinding time accrued), and you gain the Fatigued Debuff (see *Debuffs in Rules for Survival*, p. 44).

EXPERIENCE POINTS

Many roleplaying games handle character-leveling using experience points to represent a character’s learning and path toward mastery. In the *Dungeon Crawler Carl* novels, the system does assign experience points, but their use is poorly understood even by veteran or retired crawlers. My algorithm is incredibly opaque by design, partly due to crawlers’ repeated attempts to game the system and partly due to centuries of spaghetti code baked into the process.

The **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** doesn’t use experience points at all because its designers are flesh-monkeys like you who quickly gave up trying to figure out Syndicate math. For simplicity’s sake, characters gain levels simply by playing the game. Life (or death) in the dungeon is tough enough as it is. Don’t overcomplicate it.

Here are some basics:

Two-Hours: At the end of every 2 hours of play, each party member gains 1 level.

Quests: When a crawler or party completes a Quest, they gain at least 1 level—more if the Quest took place across multiple floors. (Your GM will use discretion here.)

Crawler Killers: Killing other crawlers is a great way to earn extra levels! Each time you kill a crawler, you gain 1d6 levels modified by your level difference. If you are a lower level than your victim, add the difference in levels to your result, up to a maximum of gaining 15 levels from one kill! If you are equal or a higher level than your victim, subtract the difference to a minimum of 1 level gained.

Grinding: When crawlers grind to raise their Skill Ranks, they occasionally level up during the process, though it is slow.

Bosses: When a party kills a Boss, each member gains levels based on the tier of the Boss. Your GM can modify the number if the assault was very easy or very hard. Whoever lands the killing blow often earns a higher quality loot box but not extra levels.

- **Neighborhood Boss:** Gain 1 level
- **Borough Boss:** Gain 2 levels
- **City Boss:** Gain 3 levels
- **Province Boss:** Gain 4 levels
- **Country Boss:** Gain 5 levels
- **Floor Boss:** Gain 6 levels

Neighborhood Maps and Borough Field Guides make grinding more efficient, because crawlers can avoid lulls in the action. If you grind for 5 or more hours, you accrue 1 bonus hour to your grinding time if you have a Neighborhood Map or 2 bonus hours if you have a Borough Field Guide. This allows you to grind for 5 hours (the safe limit per day) but get credit for 6 hours with a Neighborhood Map and 7 hours with a Field Guide.

Crawlers declare how many hours they wish to grind, then the GM rolls on the Table 2: Tutorial Floor Grinding Complications in the *Game Master's Campaign Toolkit*, p. 13, to determine if anything affects the grind.

GRINDING SKILLS

At the end of the grind, choose any Skill (doesn't have to be combat-related) to accrue the hours you earned. Attempting to Advance a Skill requires accruing grinding hours equal to its current Rank, but these hours need not be continuous or happen on the same day. They may accumulate from one day or even one floor to the next, so keep track of your grinding hours on your character sheet, perhaps in the "Notes" section on your "Skills" list.

When you have accumulated grinding hours in a Skill equal to your current Rank in that Skill, immediately roll a Skill Advancement Check for that Skill. Any penalties from Debuffs (Fatigued is common) apply to this check.

If you roll equal to or higher than your current Skill Rank, you immediately gain 1 Rank in that Skill. Regardless of the result, you cannot grind the same Skill more than once per day, because too much grinding leaves you raw and chapped. Give it a rest!

If you've been grinding for more hours than needed for a particular Skill, apply any additional hours to another Skill (you can't bank hours for the same Skill). You may grind and track hours for multiple Skills at the same time if you wish.

Example: If you grind for four hours, you can make a Skill Advancement Check for four Skills at Rank 1, two at Rank 2, or even one at Rank 3 and then apply the remaining hour to a Rank 2 Skill. Note that hour of progress on the Rank 2 Skill's "Notes" section.

LEVELING UP VIA GRINDING

"Experience is earned through repetition. So is despair." —My Chemical Romance (probably)

While you grind for Skills, you progress toward leveling up as well. Keep a running total of all your grinding hours and erase it only when you level up. No, I'm not going to do it for you.

You gain a level when you grind a number of hours equal to your current level (6 hours to advance from level 6 to 7, for example). The party member with the lowest level gains 1d2 levels when they level up this way. If there is a tie for lowest, no one rolls 1d2.

